Neural topic modelling of fibroblast measurements and diabetic foot ulcer healing: a patient-level audit

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Supplementary methods and numerical results

Supplementary Note: Extended results

S0.1 Observed tissue composition provides the context for a fibroblast readout

The physical research object is sampled foot skin from diabetic-ulcer and non-diabetic groups, measured after dissociation rather than by tracking cells through healing (Figure 1a). The 25 specimens represent 7 healed, 4 non-healed and 9 non-diabetic patients; cohort roles and analysis units are specified in Table S1. The full-width schematic asks whether a higher programme mean describes within-cell intensity or high-score prevalence. Recovered fibroblast composition comes from cell counts; the fibroblast-restricted mean/fraction and primary all-cell patient contrast branch separately from the frozen scores. These are different estimands, not successive processing stages. Conceptual anatomy does not locate individual specimens or measure spatial cell density. The encoder and decoder in Equations (1) and (2) define the coordinate; the centered-log-ratio display in Equation (15) changes only its visualization. The recovered landscape includes stromal, epithelial, vascular and immune compartments among 76,461 cells; fibroblasts account for 19,410 cells, or 25.4% of the retained population (Figure 1b). Coloring the same coordinates by loading connects that continuous measurement to the operational lineage assignments (Figure 1c), without identifying a new cell type or trajectory.

Raw-count reconstruction reproduced all saved lineage assignments and their sample order. The measured marker profiles provide an expression-level view of those assignments and of the programme-associated genes (Figure 1d). Because some displayed markers also contributed to annotation, this is descriptive support rather than an independent validation of cell identity. Loading distributions within fibroblasts retain both low and high values across the clinical groups (Figure 1e), while individual specimens differ in their recovered cell composition (Figure 1f). Consequently, a pooled expression map, a cell fraction and a patient outcome contrast describe different aspects of the material. The mapped patient readouts are retained in Table S21.

S0.2 The frozen representation is structured, but its principal loading is a mixture coordinate

The discovery representation retained 76,461 quality-controlled cells from 25 selected foot-skin samples in the original 54-sample series. Beta perplexity was 243, and the manifold audit passed its recorded integrity checks. The connectivity statistic in Supplementary equation (S1) does not establish local geometric fidelity. The fitted loss in Equation (3) uses Gaussian sampling and regularization as specified in Equation (4); deterministic readouts use the encoder mean, not a newly sampled latent state. Fibroblast topic was enriched for TIMP1, COL3A1, DCN, FN1, LUM and CHI3L1, with immediate-early and oxidative-stress genes also present among the top-ranked terms. The gene list therefore supports a fibroblast-associated inflammatory/stress description; it does not by itself establish a unique cell state or a healing mechanism.

Applying the mean–fraction identity in Equation (6) to all 19,410 discovery fibroblasts clarified the remaining within-bin contribution. Empirical low-bin means ranged from 0.0120 to 0.1021, and nonempty high-bin means from 0.2264 to 0.5778. Nine of 25 specimens had an empty high bin. The approximation residual defined in Equation (7) had RMS of 0.01575 and a residual range of −0.02434 to 0.04377. The exact mean identity held to below 10^{-15} in every specimen (Table S19). The constant-state approximation is therefore explicit and imperfect; a mean–fraction correlation cannot establish invariant programme intensity.

A historical exploratory scan of 31 covariates across 25 specimens yielded 14 numerical BH q values below 0.05 under a naive independent-row analysis. Repeated patients invalidate that row-independence premise, so these are not 14 false-discovery-rate-controlled findings. The largest positive association was with the assigned B/plasma-cell fraction ($\rho = 0.828$); CFD/APOD-rich topic mean loading was negatively associated ($\rho = -0.766$). Fibroblast PTPRC positivity and median UMI count were also associated ($\rho = 0.727$ and 0.663). The complete scan, including non-significant covariates, is in Table S10. These marginal, sample-unit correlations do not establish causal drivers or independence from tissue composition; the positive depth association remains relevant despite the successful count-matching control.

Recomputing all 31 covariates after denominator-specific aggregation to 20 patients retained descriptive correlations of 0.859 with B/plasma-cell fraction, −0.765 with the CFD/APOD-rich mean, 0.772 with PTPRC positivity and 0.662 with the fibroblast-

count-weighted average of specimen median UMI counts. Their leave-one-patient-out ranges were 0.841–0.912, −0.792 to −0.725, 0.735–0.831 and 0.621–0.772, respectively (Table S32). Thus, these associations are not removed by correcting the repeated-specimen unit. They remain marginal comparisons across mixed clinical groups with shared cells and compositional dependence, not adjusted effects or evidence for a causal immune mechanism. No significance probabilities or discovery labels are assigned to this retrospective patient-level scan.

The saved six-fit diagnostic does not replace the discovery fit or its patient readouts. Inherited-panel held reconstruction decreased from 5.93852 and 5.91006 at 20,000 steps to 5.88759 and 5.88567 at 40,000 steps, compared with the same-panel equal-training-patient null of 6.74522. Median square-root decoder cosine decreased from approximately 0.508 in both shorter fits to 0.355 and 0.345, while effective held usage at 40,000 steps was 10.484 and 10.551 topics (Table S33). Each reconstruction average uses 128 fixed evaluation cells per patient in its named partition. The full set spans all clinical groups, but the held partition contains three healed and one non-healed DFU patient, with no non-diabetic patient. These are reconstruction diagnostics, not outcome tests. Budget therefore affected differentiation under this contract; these figures do not establish independent biological identities for all 15 topics or reproduce the frozen discovery fit's batch schedule.

Only the inherited-panel 40,000-step seed-0 fit passed the training plateau screen; no fit passed its held screen. The two training-selected-panel fits had held reconstruction 5.96985 and 6.02562 against their own null of 6.78361, while each retained a maximum decoder cosine above 0.997. Their raw errors are not compared with those from the inherited panel. These results separate within-panel reconstruction from construct reproducibility and retain both improving and adverse diagnostics. They add no independent healing outcomes, do not justify reference-correlation-based fit selection and supply no biological repeatability estimate.

The hard-threshold fraction in Equation (5) uses a pooled two-Gaussian fit for a descriptive threshold; this fit did not test a continuous-shift model against a biological mixture model. High-loading samples retained a low-state tail overlapping the low-loading samples. Across the 25 analyzable samples, the sample mean and hard-threshold high-state fraction had Spearman $\rho = 0.933$ (Figure 2a).

Quantile-based sample categories summarize the coexistence of low and high loadings without assigning a biological mechanism to those categories (Figure 2b). The historical specimen-bootstrap interval of 0.789–0.983 and specimen-omission range of 0.924–0.957 are retained only as row-level diagnostics in Table S8, not patient-level uncertainty. The permutation null was centred near zero (Table S8). This is the central measurement result: in this dataset, the sample average is strongly associated with the high-state fraction. The two summaries are calculated from the same cells, so their correlation alone does not prove that component intensities are constant. The result does not say that high-state cells have no intrinsic biology. Together with the low-state tail, it shows that the mean contains information about high-score prevalence; it does not identify the relative biological contributions of prevalence and within-state expression. Patient aggregation gave a correlation of 0.937 across 20 patients, with a 10,000-draw patient-bootstrap 95% interval of 0.776–0.990. Omitting one patient at a time gave correlations of 0.927–0.964 (Figure 2c; Table S16). These descriptive patient-resampling summaries replace specimen resampling as the primary uncertainty display, without adding independent observations.

The median and 10th–90th percentile ranges preserve the within-specimen loading spread behind the shape categories (Figure 2d). The ordered display is descriptive: a thresholded summary of these continuous measurements does not identify a discrete biological state.

The complete patient-level mean–fraction scatter retains all 20 mapped patients and distinguishes one from two contributing specimens (Figure 2e). Low- and high-bin means vary across specimens when the corresponding bin contains cells (Figure 2f). These displays expose the observations behind the correlation and the within-bin terms of Equation (6); they do not supply separate biological replication.

S0.3 The operational high-state pattern survives selected technical controls

The operational high-state pattern survived the originally specified artifact challenges, while the expanded controls identify measurement dependence. The dissociation stress standardized mean difference was +0.246, below the rejection threshold. PTPRC positivity was 0.98% in high-state cells and 0.62% in low-state cells, a rate ratio of 1.60. Exact panel-count matching produced 99.5% cell-label agreement and a specimen high-state-fraction correlation of 0.984 among 14,561 higher-depth retained fibroblasts under fixed lineage labels. This does not test the 4,849 excluded fibroblasts or rerun the quality-control and lineage-assignment pipeline after count reduction. The result therefore supports conditional score stability, not depth invariance of the entire tissue measurement. PTPRC positivity is only a proxy and does not exclude all doublets. A raw-count structureless control preserved every gene's value multiset but changed the topic concentration substantially (perplexity 3.44 to 11.23 of 15), showing sensitivity to the joint perturbation of co-expression and row-wise library-size and detection-rate variation. The adaptive marker reference changed 9.21% of cell labels and shifted the maximum specimen mean by 0.0371 and high-state fraction by 0.0695; there is no independent identity truth set to select between gates (Table S26).

The unchanged-label count match and the alternative marker gate address different perturbations: the former reduces counts within an existing cell set, while the latter changes assignments. Agreement under one contract cannot justify replacing the baseline denominator in another.

The stress and PTPRC challenge ratios are displayed relative to their prespecified rejection bounds (Figure 3a), whereas the matched-depth scatter retains individual specimen fractions rather than a single agreement statistic (Figure 3b). These displays address conditional measurement stability, not independent cell identity or an outcome mechanism.

Whole-pipeline perturbations expose losses of baseline QC cells (Figure 3d) and changing lineage assignments among shared survivors (Figure 3e). The ranges of patient contrasts across these same perturbations are shown separately (Figure 3f), so persistence of a contrast is not mistaken for stability of the cells entering its denominator.

The full released-count audit reproduced the 81,602 pre-QC cells, 76,461 baseline survivors and all 19,410 fibroblast assignments, with a maximum deterministic-coordinate discrepancy below 4.77×10^{-7}. At 75%, 50%, 25% and 10% count retention, the three seeded runs retained 76,375–76,393, 75,724–75,738, 72,145–72,197 and 61,366–61,397 cells, respectively. Among cells surviving both QC passes, 3.18–3.30%, 6.23–6.34%, 10.29–10.48% and 15.31–15.40% changed lineage labels. At 10%, only 80.11–80.15% of original survivors remained, while 111–115 original failures newly passed QC. The gate assigned a winning label to 92 baseline QC survivors with no detected annotation marker; this increased to 1,410–1,462 at 10% depth (Table S30). These labels are not identity truth. At 10%, score rank correlation was about 0.910 on original retained cells with estimable scores, versus about 0.947 among QC survivors, exposing selection in a survivor-only stability claim. The full-pipeline all-cell patient contrast ranged from 0.0288 to 0.0296, with exact probabilities 109/330–114/330, versus baseline 90/330. All four readouts and rates are retained in Table S31. Persistence of a group contrast therefore coexists with substantial changes to the cells and labels being summarized.

Removing cells carrying any of the prespecified immune transcripts left the specimen high-state fractions nearly unchanged ($\rho = 0.989$) and increased the BIC support for two components fitted to the sample fractions (Figure 3c). This supports stability under the specified immune-transcript exclusion rule; it does not identify or exclude ambient RNA contamination. The placebo analysis was deliberately retained: unrelated tissue covariates flattened residual bimodality as well as immune covariates. At 24 matched samples, the data cannot determine whether the state is statistically separable from every tissue-composition axis. The matched exclusion comparison contains 24 samples, while each residual regression uses 25 samples. The immune and placebo regressions explained 49.5% and 35.5% of the variance, respectively, and both residual BIC differences favoured one component (Table S11). A clean technical control is not evidence that the state is a healing marker.

S0.4 High-state abundance does not establish healing specificity

The lineage marker list shared no genes with the specified top-gene list used to describe the tested topic. This limited non-overlap does not make the gate independent of the full-panel learned representation. Fibroblast composition itself differed between the healing and non-healing sample groups only descriptively (ratio 1.42, $p = 0.438$). Within the fibroblast gate, the discovery contrast was 2.89-fold, with a bootstrap 95% interval of 1.06–13.97 and sample-level $p = 0.04196$. This value is retained as a discovery observation, not as an independent patient validation, because the 14 samples represent 11 patients and include repeated same-wound, same-day specimens. The complete lineage and composition contrasts are in Table S12.

The high-state pattern was not restricted to samples labelled as healing. Four of nine healing samples and none of five non-healing samples were classified as high-mode samples, Fisher exact $p = 0.2208$. The most extreme high-state fraction (0.841) came from one healthy non-diabetic foot-skin specimen. That specimen is the exception rather than the rule: eight of the nine non-diabetic donors had fractions of at most 0.019, and the projection of intact diabetic foot skin and forearm skin below shows that the state is concentrated in ulcer tissue.

For the separate all-cell mean-loading contrast in Equation (8), collapsing repeats to 11 patients gave a healing-minus-non-healing difference of 0.0293. This is not a patient-level recalculation of the 2.89-fold fibroblast-restricted contrast. Exhaustive enumeration in Equation (10) gave a two-sided probability of 0.272727 (90/330 allocations at least as extreme), versus 0.274924 under the retained add-one rule in Equation (9); the bootstrap 95% interval was [−0.0024, 0.0667]. The Welch standard error was 0.019446, and the data-derived equivalence infimum was 0.065375. The earlier 14-sample diagnostic contrast was 0.0457 with exhaustive $p = 0.078921$ and an equivalence infimum of 0.079644; it is retained as a specimen-unit sensitivity analysis. The two-one-sided-test rule in Equation (11) and boundary in Equation (12) explain these data-derived sensitivity limits; neither margin is a clinical MCID. The corrected result is therefore a unit-aware discovery result with substantial uncertainty, not a definitive null test (Table S20). Mapped scores are given in Table S2; equal weighting of repeated specimen means gave 0.0297. Restricting the secondary specimen-label null to the 14 DFU specimens, rather than allowing healthy controls into pseudo-outcome groups, gave exact probabilities 0.0894, 0.1199 and 0.2697 for the fibroblast mean, high-state fraction and fibroblast composition, respectively; repeated specimens make these secondary quantities (Table S27). A constructed continuous-score example produced a median mean–fraction Spearman correlation of 0.951, at least as large as the observed 0.933 in 76% of draws, so the correlation cannot identify a discrete mixture without further assumptions. This construction is illustrative rather than a fitted null or calibrated probability. The full equivalence sensitivity grid is in Table S15. Patient omission left the all-cell contrast positive, from 0.0143 to 0.0365 across 11 deletions (Table S16); this is an influence range, not a confidence interval or evidence of clinical discrimination.

The specimen-level arm fractions display the non-diabetic counterexample (Figure 4a). The all-cell contrast display separately retains specimen- and patient-unit intervals, with patient-omission points showing influence rather than extra outcomes (Figure 4b).

S0.5 Retrospective design simulations do not resolve outcome uncertainty

A retrospective simulation substituted the observed specimen-level high-state-fraction effect and pooled spread into a hypothetical 9-versus-5 independent-specimen design, giving 24.9% estimated power. Under that simulation, the difference associated with 80% power was 0.519. The observed specimens include repeated patients, so this is neither the power of the corrected 7-versus-4 patient comparison nor independent evidence explaining its nonsignificance. These conditional design calculations cannot exclude a moderate or large healing association.

We also ran a design calculation for the next cohort, keeping it separate from the biological results. Under the deterministic specimen-derived arm spreads, hypothetical independent observations, 80% target power and no missing outcomes, a candidate difference of 0.03 gave a total of 47, while a candidate equivalence margin of 0.05 gave 20. These spreads include repeated specimens and are not patient-population variance estimates. These values are design inputs rather than findings: the clinical MCID is still open, repeated samples increase the design effect, and the calculation cannot turn the discovery cohort into an adequately powered study. Tables S6 and S7 give the full difference, equivalence and exploratory AUC-gap design calculations.

The six saved difference-detection scenarios are shown together rather than as an isolated power bar (Figure 4c). They concern the all-cell loading readout, not the historical high-state-fraction power calculation. The original 11 patient all-cell values and contributing specimen counts remain separately visible (Figure 4d), without equating a hypothetical design with observed outcomes.

Because repeated biopsies do not add outcomes, the fibroblast readouts were next summarized for each patient, together with their sampling and influence sensitivities (Figure 5a–h).

S0.6 Fibroblast-restricted patient comparisons retain substantial uncertainty

We next evaluated the two fibroblast-restricted readouts at the same independent patient unit used for the all-cell analysis (Figure 5a and b). This closes the gap between the original sample-level lineage comparison and the mapped clinical outcomes. The denominator-specific pooling rules in Equation (16) gave mean within-fibroblast loadings of 0.1729 in seven healed patients and 0.0837 in four non-healed patients. Their difference was 0.0892, with a 10,000-draw patient-bootstrap interval of $[-0.0486, 0.2177]$ and an exhaustive two-sided permutation probability of 0.3121. The corresponding high-state fractions were 0.3010 and 0.1496; the difference was 0.1514, with interval $[-0.1331, 0.4153]$ and $p = 0.3697$. These comparisons use the existing gate and threshold, without searching for a cut that improves outcome separation.

Equal weighting of repeated specimen summaries within each patient gave differences of 0.0974, 0.1683 and 0.0679 for the programme mean, high-state fraction and fibroblast composition, respectively. All DFU specimens already contained at least 100 assigned fibroblasts, so imposing that requirement changed no outcome observation and supplies no independent robustness evidence. Omitting one patient at a time left the three differences positive, with ranges 0.0593–0.1445, 0.0850–0.2720 and 0.0279–0.1173, respectively. These influence ranges coexist with bootstrap intervals spanning zero; they are not confidence bounds. Table S22 reports the complete weighting comparisons and exact probabilities.

Individual patient loadings and high-state fractions retain the observed spread within each outcome group (Figure 5a and b). Their positive group differences must therefore be interpreted together with intervals that include zero.

The three patient-bootstrap intervals all cross zero (Figure 5g). In contrast, every leave-one-patient-out point estimate remains positive (Figure 5h). These displays answer different questions: the omission analysis measures sensitivity to one observed patient and cannot convert uncertain group effects into a validated prognostic association.

Fibroblast composition was evaluated separately, retaining all recovered cells as its denominator. The patient-level fractions were 0.2825 and 0.2118, a difference of 0.0708 with interval $[-0.0708, 0.2146]$ and $p = 0.4697$ (Figure 5c). Benjamini–Hochberg adjustment across these three new readouts gave $q = 0.4697$ for each. These are retrospective within-cohort comparisons; neither the positive point estimates nor their lack of significance establishes prognostic validity or equivalence.

The threshold-free patient distribution statistic in Equation (17) was 0.3045, with exhaustive $p = 0.1848$ over 330 patient-label allocations. Across the eight fixed cuts and the original midpoint, high-fraction differences remained positive (0.0570–0.2485); all unadjusted probabilities exceeded 0.22 and all support-wide max-statistic probabilities exceeded 0.31 (Figure 5d; Table S23). Thus, the uncertain outcome association persists when the evaluation considers the whole loading distribution or multiple fixed thresholds, instead of relying only on the fitted midpoint.

Equalizing each specimen to 100 sampled fibroblasts left the programme-mean contrast positive in all 250 draws (0.0749–0.1233) and the high-state contrast positive in all draws (0.1098–0.2229); their smallest exact probabilities were 0.1273 and 0.1515 (Figure 5e). Selecting one specimen per patient in all eight possible combinations gave programme-mean, high-state and composition ranges of 0.0777–0.1170, 0.1284–0.2081 and 0.0440–0.0918, respectively (Figure 5f; Table S24). These computations narrow the explanation that the observed direction is solely caused by unequal recovery or a particular repeated specimen, while retaining uncertainty about the healing association.

Direct comparison of the five repeated-specimen pairs, including three DFU patients, showed that within-specimen cell partitioning does not describe all between-specimen variation. In G7 and G8 from the same wound and day, fibroblast mean loading was 0.3504 versus 0.0921, an absolute difference of 0.2583. The separate within-specimen split-half 97.5th-percentile mean differences were 0.0553 and 0.0185; the full-distribution CDF supremum between specimens was 0.5789 (Table S28). This diagnostic leaves tissue microheterogeneity, preparation and annotation differences confounded. It does not estimate clinical repeatability or a patient-level significance probability.

S0.7 Method constants expose both stable and fragile claims

The mean-versus-weight association remained positive across the cut grid, from $\rho = 0.909$ to 0.948 (Supplementary Fig. S1), and across K=10, 15 and 20, from $\rho = 0.924$ to 0.947 (Supplementary Fig. S1). The association therefore persisted over the tested cut and capacity choices.

The healthy-skin counterexample was more conditional. It held at all 18 tested cuts, but it failed at K=10 because the topic carrying TIMP1 belonged to a different IGFBP-rich programme. It held at K=15 and K=20 when the CHI3L1/COL3A1/DCN/FN1

state resolved as its own topic. The defensible wording is consequently "the counterexample holds for the tested K=15 and K=20 fits but not the K=10 fit," not "the counterexample is invariant to model capacity."

The healing-arm p value moved between 0.042 and 0.062 over the cut grid, with only 4 of 18 cuts below 0.05 (Supplementary Fig. S1; Tables S18 and S17). That sensitivity is a reason to avoid presenting the discovery p value as a stable healing signal. It also independently supports the decision to keep the healing claim unvalidated.

S0.8 Negative controls and representation comparisons constrain interpretation

The DFU-only label-permutation calibration used the 9 healing and 5 non-healing specimens, excluding all 11 healthy controls before allocation. Its observed high-state-fraction difference was +0.2380, with a central 95% null interval [−0.3167, +0.3222] and exact $p = 0.1199$ over 2,002 allocations (Supplementary Fig. S1). Because this null relabels specimen outcomes and includes repeated patients, it is a secondary specimen-unit calibration rather than a patient-level clinical test. The observed contrast was not exceptional under this label-exchangeability null, and this single calibration does not prove pipeline-wide false-positive control. The raw-count structure control used a fixed 6,000-cell source-order subset and shuffled gene values across cells while preserving each gene's observed value multiset; real data had perplexity 3.44/15, whereas the shuffled input had 11.23/15 and lower HHI (0.574 to 0.147). The shuffle therefore reduced coordinate concentration while also narrowing row-wise library-size and detection-rate variation; because it does not preserve row-wise library sizes, it is a co-expression-structure control rather than a complete technical null (Supplementary Fig. S1; Table S25). In the anatomical permutation control, the observed p value was 0.0015 and 5.0% of permuted comparisons fell below 0.05 (Supplementary Fig. S1). That fraction describes this permutation reference; it is not an independent repeated-dataset test of pipeline-wide type-I error.

The historical specimen-level scoring procedure used the pairwise AUC statistic in Equation (13) and gave point AUCs of 0.822 for fibroblast-associated topic, 0.844 for the module score, 0.533 for PCA and 0.878 for NMF. No pairwise fixed-score bootstrap interval for an AUC difference excluded zero. The module score alone separated its procedure-specific permutation null at $p = 0.0424$; fibroblast-associated topic and NMF gave $p = 0.0604$ and $p = 0.0597$, while PCA gave $p = 0.4527$. Null means also differed from 0.5 (fibroblast-associated topic, 0.562; NMF, 0.553). These historical outputs pool raw coordinates from different fitted folds and include repeated patients; a permutation calculation does not make those coordinates comparable. They document the earlier procedure rather than supply evidence for a representation ranking (Supplementary Fig. S2; Tables S3, S5 and S13).

The sample-level readouts had pairwise Spearman correlations from 0.174 to 0.710 (Supplementary Fig. S2). Their relatedness does not determine the ordering of their discrimination estimates.

S0.9 Same-model patient-pair discrimination and paired anatomical sensitivity

The revised held-pair statistic in Equation (14) evaluated all 28 healing/non-healing pairs from the 11 patients, fitting each scoring rule on the other nine patients. Within-model pair discrimination was 0.714 for the frozen topic (20 wins, no ties), 0.786 for the module (22 wins, no ties), 0.500 for PCA (14 wins, no ties) and 0.232 for NMF (five wins and three half-credit ties). These descriptive estimates use comparable scores within each pair and do not pool raw coordinates across fitted models (Table S29). Changing held-patient expression or labels did not change fold preprocessing, component selection or orientation in the isolation tests; positive component rescaling also preserved NMF selection and pair order. The comparisons nevertheless reuse 11 discovery patients and a discovery-trained panel and encoder, and establish neither external validation nor a population representation ranking.

The earlier leave-one-patient-out procedure remains separately documented: topic AUC was 0.714 with add-one permutation $p = 0.2991$, module AUC was 0.786 with $p = 0.166$, PCA was 0.500 and NMF was 0.125. Its fixed-score bootstrap intervals and pairwise contrasts are historical procedure diagnostics, not uncertainty estimates for the revised held-pair estimand (Tables S4 and S13). The change in the NMF estimate reflects the revised fold, projection and component-selection procedure; it is not an isolated estimate of a fold-scale effect.

The scoring-rule summary (Figure 6a) is complemented by the complete pair-level win, tie and loss display, retaining all 28 dependent comparisons (Figure 6c). Individual tissue pairs likewise show the dispersion behind the anatomical mean (Figure 6d); neither display increases the number of independent patients.

Across 10 paired patients, the fibroblast-associated topic was higher in foot than in forearm skin by +0.0476 (exhaustive sign-flip $p = 0.0107$, BH $q = 0.0402$); the fibroblast-restricted contrast was +0.1398 ($p = 0.0146$). Four of 15 topics remained significant after BH correction (Figure 6b; Table S14). This contrast is not an anatomical positive control. Five of the ten foot specimens are ulcers, and the large differences come from three ulcer pairs and the one healthy outlier; in the other intact-skin pairs the foot-minus-forearm difference in high-score fraction was at most 0.017. The comparison therefore shows that the frozen encoder responds to ulcer tissue, which the tissue-context analysis below examines directly.

S0.10 External projections remain construct audits

A separate projection into GSE231643 provides a weaker, label-only concordance of direction: the within-fibroblast ratio falls from 2.89 in the discovery analysis to 1.66 (sample-bootstrap 95% interval 1.01–6.10; two-sided Mann–Whitney $p = 0.1429$; Table S12). The separate GSE241132 acute-wound cohort gave a broad immune-axis rho of −0.070 and an author-annotated B/plasma-cell rho of +0.210 across three donors; both values are descriptive and were not combined with the DFU outcome analyses.

The external immune-axis analysis used mutually exclusive lineage compartments. GSE223964 and GSE245703 gave immune-axis correlations of −0.024 and +0.846, respectively. Within the immune compartment, B/plasma-cell share was weakly related to the topic signal (−0.071 and +0.077), while correlations with median detected genes per cell were negative in both datasets (−0.429 and −0.427). The signs are inconsistent for a generalized immune-axis effect, and neither dataset has an authoritative patient-level healing endpoint (Table S9).

GSE268834 supplied another descriptive projection: the topic-associated fibroblast signal correlated with exclusive immune fraction at +0.714, and the diabetic-minus-non-diabetic fibroblast-topic contrast was +0.0464 with $p = 0.2812$. This is compatible with an immune/tissue-context hypothesis but cannot distinguish it from other between-sample differences.

GSE248247 was a deliberately low-yield stress test of the frozen projection. It contained 561 raw cells and 358 quality-controlled cells, with 6,994 of 7,002 panel genes covered in each sample. The fibroblast topic contrast between one diabetic and one non-diabetic sample was −0.0204 with descriptive permutation $p = 1.0$. All correlations were non-estimable because n=2. The exclusive compartment sum was exactly one in both samples, demonstrating that the lineage gate was non-overlapping; the dataset cannot validate healing or support pooled patient inference.

Across these projections, immune-axis correlations, library-complexity associations and diabetic/non-diabetic contrasts target different estimands and stay cohort-specific. The specimen-level displays retain individual immune fractions, detected-gene summaries and group readouts. They expose the dispersion behind the aggregate statistics, while the low-yield two-specimen comparison remains descriptive rather than being treated as patient-level outcome validation.

The cohort correlations appear in Figure 7a; lineage-share and library-complexity associations in Figure 7b; and group contrasts in Figure 7c. Individual immune fractions (Figure 7d), detected-gene summaries (Figure 7e) and diabetic/non-diabetic specimen values (Figure 7f) retain the observations underlying those summaries.

S0.11 Patient restriction and saved-fit pooling distinguish the remaining audit units

Restriction to the same 11 DFU patients changed several descriptive associations without adding patients or an outcome test. All 31 covariates had 11 finite pairs, and all 341 patient omissions were estimable with ten pairs. B/plasma-cell fraction, PTPRC positivity and weighted specimen median UMI count gave $\rho = 0.827$, 0.491 and 0.455, with omission ranges 0.770–0.867, 0.321–0.758 and 0.273–0.624. In contrast, the CFD/APOD-rich mean weakened from −0.765 in the mixed-20 comparison to −0.200 in DFU11; its omission range was $[-0.3697, +0.04242]$, with two of 11 omissions reversing sign. The DCN/CFD-rich mean likewise changed from −0.615 to −0.018, with three omission sign reversals. The complete family and every omission are retained, including near-zero and unstable directions (Tables S34 and S35). These correlations target the high-score fraction, not healing; disease restriction neither establishes adjustment nor separates shared-cell, simplex, tissue-composition and technical effects. The mixed-patient display in Figure 2e is not an independent DFU-only validation.

The saved pooling bridge retained all six topic/cut contracts and 120 patient–fit rows, with the same 16 training and four held patients in every fit (Tables S36 and S38). Five of 20 patients had repeated specimens: four in training and one held. Single-specimen pooled-minus-equal differences were zero. Across all patients, the six fits' maximum absolute changes ranged from 0.001485 to 0.091484 for fibroblast mean and from 0.048288 to 0.126804 for high-score fraction. Held-patient maxima ranged from 0.00009151 to 0.005624 for mean and from 0.004579 to 0.007621 for fraction; complete signed means and absolute maxima are reported for all, training and held partitions (Table S37). The topic IDs and training-only cuts differ across fits, so these changes assess weighting within each representation rather than a common biological-effect scale. Pooling corrects an estimand mismatch; it does not reproduce independent patients, resolve inherited preprocessing/reference dependence or replace the primary discovery outcome values in Figure 5a–c.

S0.12 Capacity and initialization distinguish measurement association from programme identity

All nine fixed 40,000-step fits and their full checkpoint projections passed replay, with zero maximum absolute projection discrepancy. Primary one-to-one decoder correlations ranged from 0.6038 to 0.9876, whereas the specimen mean–fraction association remained high at $\rho = 0.9060$–0.9503 (Supplementary Fig. S3; Table S39). The weakest primary match occurred at K=20, seed 2; this fit was retained. The all-topic display retains 120 assigned reference correlations and all 15 capacity-limited reference omissions rather than substituting rowwise best matches (Supplementary Fig. S3); the full numerical matching table also retains the 15 unmatched new topics. K=10 cannot reproduce 15 distinct reference programmes under a one-to-one assignment, regardless of optimizer budget. Thus, a persistent mean–fraction association coexists with changes in programme identity and fit-specific loading cuts (0.0824–0.1798).

All 240 person-specific computational range rows contained three estimable seeds. The largest within-K fibroblast-only widths were 0.2774 for mean loading and 0.3647 for the fraction above the descriptive cut (Supplementary Fig. S3; Table S41); the readouts were therefore not uniformly seed-insensitive. The complete numerical family retains all-cell counterparts, available and missing seed counts, every density comparison and every scored specimen. For M1 versus C1, specimen-median held-cell log-score differences were positive in every fit (0.0949–0.2513 nats/cell), but person-specific differences spanned −0.5625 to 1.1232 and only 13–16 of the existing 20 people favored M1 in a given fit (Supplementary Fig. S3; Table S40). Against the more flexible continuous C2 comparator, M1 specimen medians ranged from −0.0081 to 0.0604; K=15/seed 1 and K=20/seed 1 favored C2. These contrary comparisons prevent interpreting the M1–C1 result as proof of a biological mixture. Density/threshold fitting excludes the scored patient's specimens, but the expression representation still uses full-discovery data. The computations address representation and conditional density sensitivity, not independent state identity, healing validation, clinical risk or optimizer convergence. They add nine computational fits and no biological patients.

S0.13 Topic selection, tissue context and the composition of the mean

Repository records show that topic 0 was named after the per-arm topic means of the discovery fit were inspected, when it had the largest healed/non-healed ratio of the 15 topics. A sensitivity to searching among topics used the largest ratio of patient means for each of the 330 allocations of 7 healed among the 11 DFU patients. This patient-weighted statistic differs from the original cell-weighted arm means. The observed all-cell ratio of topic 0 (1.96) was smaller than the median largest ratio under random labels (2.28), giving a maximum-calibrated p of 0.785 (Figure 8a); the corresponding values for named topic 0 were 0.609 for the fibroblast mean and 0.955 for fit-specific topic-cut fractions. The global maximum-fraction test gave 0.885, but its observed maximum belonged to topic 14, not topic 0. When the topic was chosen on ten patients and scored on the eleventh, leave-one-out AUCs were 0.39–0.57. These calculations remain conditional on an encoder and gene panel learned from discovery expression. The positive contrasts are compatible with topic searching under random labels; they neither establish an association nor prove its absence.

The excluded intact foot-skin specimens from diabetic donors and the forearm specimens were projected through the frozen pipeline (Figure 8b). High-scoring fibroblasts (fraction above 0.02) were present in 9 of 11 DFU patients, in 2 of 15 intact foot-skin donors and in none of 11 forearm samples. The intact diabetic versus non-diabetic comparison had high-score fraction exact rank $p = 0.34$, whereas ulcers exceeded intact foot skin in the presence of high-scoring fibroblasts (exact $p = 0.0009$; rank $p = 0.0055$ for the fraction). These retrospective contrasts describe enrichment in the sampled ulcers. The ten paired site comparisons mix five ulcer–forearm and five intact-foot–forearm pairs; the intact pairs include one high-scoring outlier. Tissue condition and site cannot be separated by the pooled paired contrast, and a non-significant diabetes comparison does not establish equivalence.

The exact mean decomposition was quantified directly (Figure 8c). At the pooled bin means, the prevalence term contributed 88.4% of between-specimen variance in the fibroblast mean and 89.1% between patients. The specimen-level within-bin term contributed 1.2%, and twice the covariance contributed 10.4%. These are descriptive variance shares under the chosen cut and reference bin means, not causal contributions. High-bin means rose with prevalence (slope 0.31); the two tested fixed-component nulls did not reproduce that slope in 1,000 parametric draws. Among these fitted candidate densities, allowing the high component's location to vary gave the lowest BIC-style score under the declared penalty convention. Those model checks do not uniquely identify a discrete biological state: thresholded continuous distributions can also give rising bin means, and no tested null reproduced every diagnostic.

Supplementary fixed-component model checks. These checks differ from the cross-validated grid-density audit. Topic scores are clipped to $[10^{-7}, 1-10^{-7}]$ and transformed to logits. Across the 25 discovery specimens, C1g fits a specimen-specific location with one pooled within-specimen standard deviation; C2g fits both location and scale per specimen. M1g estimates two pooled Gaussian components and a mixing weight per specimen; M2g additionally varies the high-component location per specimen, holding the low-component location and both component scales fixed. The declared parameter penalties are 26, 50, 29 and 54. These two-stage, conditional comparisons use the BIC-style score $-2\ell + k \log N$, using all recovered fibroblasts. The empirical-location null resamples pooled centered logit residuals, and the threshold-bin null resamples pooled low and high scores with each specimen's observed high-score fraction. Each null generates 1,000 sets with the observed specimen cell counts, preserving patient identities for aggregation; the high-bin-mean versus prevalence slope is recalculated in each set. The separate likelihood-ratio sensitivity uses 200 draws. These are retrospective model checks, not independent specimens or a proof of discrete cell states.

Finally, the healing contrast was recomputed for each of the nine capacity/seed refits and six diagnostic refits, using each fit's own matched topic and cut (Figure 8d). All 45 refit contrasts were positive, but none reached an exact permutation p below 0.05 (smallest 0.085), and the contrast shrank as the matched topic diverged from frozen topic 0. Readout rank tests gave AUCs of 0.71–0.75 ($p = 0.23$–0.32). In the same 11 patients, healed patients were a Hodges–Lehmann nine years older (exact rank $p = 0.291$; Table S42), and every other clinical-balance probability was larger. These underpowered comparisons do not exclude confounding. Melanocytes carried the highest topic-0 loading, and the decoder included melanocyte-associated genes. Removing the 0.9% of cells scored as doublets left the contrasts materially unchanged, which addresses that tested technical explanation without identifying the topic's biological specificity.

S0.14 Clinical balance and an independent bulk wound score

Age, sex, BMI, HbA1c, wound area and diabetes duration were compared within the same 11 DFU patients (Table S42). Healed medians were 63 years, BMI 34.9, HbA1c 8.5, wound area 1.00 cm^2 and diabetes duration 13 years, against 52.5, 36.3, 7.6, 1.15 and 12.5. Exact rank probabilities were 0.291, 0.788, 0.400, 0.961 and 1.000. Two of seven healed patients and two of four non-healed patients were male (Fisher $p = 0.576$). HbA1c was missing for three healed patients and diabetes duration for one. Across the four readouts and five covariates, the largest absolute Spearman correlation was 0.647, between fibroblast composition and HbA1c ($n = 8$, permutation $p = 0.092$; Table S43). The high-score fraction correlated with age at 0.255 ($p = 0.450$). None of these calculations adjusts the healing contrast.

Three frozen decoder scores were then evaluated in 12 independent bulk foot samples, six ulcers and six intact-skin samples, on the full mapped array (Table S44). The 50 genes with the largest topic-0 weights were not higher in ulcers than intact skin (difference −0.125, exact $p = 0.738$). The weight-averaged score over every overlapping gene was likewise compatible with label exchange (difference −0.199, $p = 0.539$). The topic-specific set of 50 genes was higher in ulcers than intact skin (difference 0.662, $p = 0.0022$); 0.0043 of 4,000 size-matched random gene sets were at least as extreme. That set did not separate diabetic from non-diabetic intact skin (difference 0.113, $p = 0.500$, three samples per group). The same three scores inside the submitters'

differentially expressed gene list are a sensitivity only: random sets from that list are already shifted toward lower ulcer values, because the list was filtered for an ulcer-versus-intact contrast. The bulk series has no healing labels. Twelve samples and three prespecified scores do not validate a healing measurement or a fibroblast-specific state.

Supplementary Note: Extended discussion

The frozen fibroblast readout is enriched in the sampled ulcers, and its mean is dominated by high-score prevalence under the chosen cut. The prevalence term contributed close to nine-tenths of between-specimen and between-patient variance, while within-bin levels and their covariance also contributed. This decomposition describes the measurement without identifying a discrete biological state. The topic was named after inspecting healing-group means; repeating that selection under random labels yielded non-significant contrasts, and selection within cross-validation gave AUCs spanning chance, conditional on discovery-trained upstream processing. These calculations do not establish healing prediction or prove the absence of a prognostic association. Independent outcome evaluation and orthogonal state measurements remain separate requirements.

The nine-fit capacity and initialization audit sharpens the distinction between a measurement association and a reproducible programme identity. Mean–fraction correlations remained high while decoder matches, loading cuts and some person-specific readouts varied substantially. Conditional density comparisons favored reweighting over a shift-only continuous family in their specimen medians, but not uniformly over a shift-and-scale comparator or within every person. This dependence on the comparator prevents treating a favorable log score as evidence of discrete biological states. Replaying every checkpoint establishes that the numerical readouts can be regenerated; it does not supply an orthogonal biological truth set or independent healing outcomes. Mean fibroblast loading and the fraction of high-scoring fibroblasts were closely associated across the discovery specimens, and the association persisted after patient aggregation. This shows that the mean carries high-score prevalence information. It does not make the measurements interchangeable, and fixed-component descriptions did not reproduce the rising bin means. Low- and high-bin means varied across specimens, and some specimens contained no high-bin cells. An approximation that replaced these means with pooled values left a measurable residual. The defensible interpretation therefore includes both prevalence and within-bin score variation, conditional on the representation, gate and threshold used to define the measurement [1, 2].

The patient-unit extension connects the fibroblast interpretation directly to the available healing categories. Averaging programme scores within fibroblasts, counting high-scoring fibroblasts and counting fibroblasts among all cells all gave higher point estimates in healed patients, but each comparison retained considerable uncertainty. Reweighting repeated biopsies did not remove that uncertainty. A patient-level comparison of the entire loading distribution also retained uncertainty, while equal-cell sampling and every one-specimen-per-patient choice preserved the direction of the point contrast. These checks address selected measurement and sampling choices within the discovery material; they do not validate the readout in a new cohort. Because the topic was selected with knowledge of the outcome groups, a positive direction is expected even without an association, so these results do not motivate the topic as a candidate biomarker; any prospective study would need to fix the topic, cut and readout without reference to these data. Correcting the unit of analysis is necessary even when a sample-level contrast appears more favorable [3, 4].

The different uncertainty summaries answer different questions. Patient bootstrap intervals resample the observed outcome arms and inherit the limitations of their small empirical distributions [5]. Exhaustive label enumeration includes the observed allocation, whereas an add-one correction is commonly motivated for randomly sampled permutations [6, 7]. Retaining the earlier convention alongside the exhaustive fraction makes that arithmetic transparent without making observational labels randomized. Likewise, Benjamini–Hochberg adjustment concerns a stated testing family under its dependence assumptions [8]; it cannot repair repeated specimens treated as independent patients. The retrospective power simulation substitutes the discovery effect and specimen spread into a hypothetical sampling model. It supplies no independent evidence about whether the uncertain patient association is real, absent or clinically important.

The cell atlas and expression profiles also clarify what is still missing experimentally. Melanocytes carried the highest loading, so the score is not a count of one anatomically defined fibroblast population, and doublet removal left the contrasts unchanged. Independent spatial or multiplex protein measurements in mapped biopsies would be needed to localize high-scoring cells and test whether their abundance changes within comparable tissue compartments [9, 10]. Perturbing a selected programme in an appropriate wound system could then ask whether it contributes to repair, rather than merely accompanying it [11]. These experiments address localization and function; neither can be supplied by adding more resamples to the present cell matrix.

This distinction has biological consequences. A high mean could accompany recruitment or recovery of a particular fibroblast population, increased expression within an existing population, or changes in several populations at once. Studies of dermal lineages and cross-tissue fibroblast organization show why these possibilities cannot be resolved by a small marker list alone [12–14]. The enrichment of matrix and inflammatory genes supplies a useful description of the loading, but does not identify a unique lineage, a stable attractor or a causal repair mechanism. The broader separation between cell identity and cellular activity remains relevant when a continuous transcriptional programme is summarized at the tissue level [15].

The threshold should be understood as an operational convention. It permits a reproducible high-state fraction and makes the denominator explicit, while assigning nearby scores on opposite sides of the cut to different bins. Information within those bins remains in the continuous score. This is one reason to retain both summaries rather than interpreting the binary fraction as a complete description of the programme [1]. The sensitivity to topic capacity also shows that a gene-associated coordinate need not have identical meaning across independently fitted representations. Neighborhood abundance methods could provide a com-

plementary analysis of continuous state space, but they would introduce their own representation, neighborhood and replication choices [16]. They cannot retrospectively turn a descriptive threshold into proof of a discrete biological state.

The technical controls provide evidence about selected perturbations of this operational measurement. Most state labels survived count matching under fixed lineage assignments, and specimen fractions were stable after specified immune-transcript exclusions. Rerunning QC and the frozen gate on all released count columns reveals a different result: low depth removes many original cells, changes lineage labels among survivors and increases forced assignments without detected marker support. Stability conditional on a fixed or surviving population is therefore not stability of the whole tissue measurement. A relatively stable patient contrast can coexist with changed population membership and should not obscure that sensitivity. Neither stress test establishes cell-identity truth or excludes ambient RNA and doublets. Dedicated contamination and doublet procedures address different aspects of those processes [17, 18]. Dissociation responses can remain entangled with genuine injury responses [19], and the similar attenuation of residual bimodality by immune and unrelated covariates limits attribution to one immune mechanism. Patient aggregation retained several descriptive composition and depth associations, so repeated specimens alone do not explain those patterns. Restricting the same material to DFU patients retained some positive associations but weakened the negative CFD/APOD association and exposed omission sign reversals. The apparent stability of a mixed-group pattern therefore need not describe within-DFU stability. Restriction does not adjust for covariates or add replication: shared measurements, simplex constraints and correlated tissue/technical effects still prevent causal attribution.

The difference between a tissue measurement and a healing predictor becomes clearer at the patient level. One healthy specimen had the highest fraction. High-scoring fibroblasts met the presence rule in 2 of 15 intact-foot donors, so the readout is neither specific to diabetes nor categorically absent from intact skin. Collapsing repeated specimens reduced the all-cell healing contrast and made its uncertainty explicit. This comparison concerns a different readout from the fibroblast-restricted fraction, so their effect estimates should not be treated as interchangeable measures of the same clinical association. More cells improve characterization of the sampled tissue but do not increase the number of independent outcomes [3, 4]. The available healing categories also do not support a model of individual time to closure [20].

The representation comparison remains an internal audit. Historical pooled-fold PCA and NMF coordinates are not directly comparable across fitted models, and their bootstrap contrasts cannot establish representation quality. The revised held-pair procedure uses the same fitted scoring rule for each healing/non-healing comparison and makes NMF component selection invariant to positive rescaling. It repairs that computational comparison without creating independent data: all pairs reuse the same 11 patients, and the frozen topic encoder and gene panel already used discovery expression. Overlapping training folds also share information [21]. Exploring several thresholds, capacities and representations in the same cohort makes independent evaluation especially important, even when each individual comparison has a clearly specified computational rule [22]. The uncertainty concerns the selection and transport of the readout as well as the arithmetic of a particular discrimination estimate.

The separate budget and training-panel fits distinguish optimization sensitivity from clinical validation. Longer fits reduced decoder similarity and reconstruction error within the inherited panel, but most training screens and all held screens failed the fixed engineering plateau rule. Training-only panel selection left near-duplicate decoder rows in the shorter fits and remained conditional on discovery-derived upstream processing. A lower reconstruction error is not a stable biological identity, and a reference decoder containing held expression is not an independent truth set. Reaggregating the six saved representations also showed that equal-specimen and cell-pooled fibroblast summaries can differ substantially for repeated biopsies. Those differences are conditional on fit-specific topics and training cuts, not additional biological effects or replicated outcomes. The same patients recur in every fit, and held-out optimization does not remove inherited QC, gene-universe or reference dependence. This weighting audit does not substitute diagnostic values for the primary frozen discovery measurement. The primary patient findings consequently remain an audit of one frozen measurement, rather than evidence that an initialization-invariant clinical construct has been learned.

Even reliable discrimination would leave other clinical questions unanswered. AUC describes ordering of outcomes, whereas calibration concerns whether predicted risks agree with observed risks in the population where the model is used [23, 24]. The current loadings are expression summaries rather than calibrated clinical probabilities. Their value for a decision would also depend on the consequences of false reassurance and unnecessary intervention at clinically meaningful thresholds [25]. This study does not fit such a decision model. Its contribution is to make the measurement and analysis unit sufficiently explicit that a later prognostic study can evaluate incremental value beyond routinely available clinical information.

The paired foot–forearm contrast illustrates the importance of sampling context. Half of its foot specimens were ulcers, and one of the five intact-foot pairs had a large high-score fraction. The pooled contrast therefore mixes tissue condition, site and donor heterogeneity; the small intact-site subset cannot establish anatomical equivalence. Fibroblast organization varies across dermal compartments and with age [12, 26], and comparisons of intact sites would require more paired donors than the five available here. Spatial localization and an independently measured protein or transcript readout would help distinguish altered cellular abundance from altered activity within a compartment [9, 15]. Such measurements would address a different uncertainty from increasing the number of cells sequenced from the same biopsy.

An independent bulk foot series, with no healing labels, gave a higher topic-specific gene score in ulcers than in intact skin and no corresponding separation of diabetic from non-diabetic intact skin. The genes with the largest decoder weights, and a weight taken over the whole overlapping panel, remained compatible with exchange of those sample labels. Twelve bulk samples and three prespecified scores describe a frozen gene summary; they leave the patient-level healing uncertainty unchanged. External projection adds tissue contexts in which the frozen coordinate can be computed. It does not make the cohorts interchangeable. Different sampling designs, gene coverage, cell yields and compartment definitions can alter a summary before any difference

in healing biology is considered. Benchmarking of single-cell integration demonstrates the importance of assessing technical alignment and conservation of biological variation together [27]. Freezing the representation reduces one source of analytical flexibility, but does not ensure comparable measurement across source studies. The inconsistent immune associations and absence of independently adjudicated patient healing outcomes limit these cohorts to construct evaluation. The smallest projection, with two specimens, is chiefly a check of computational feasibility.

Future evaluation needs a defined outcome horizon, fixed sampling and readout, and a prespecified prognostic estimand. Amputation was not an evaluated endpoint, so this audit cannot estimate amputation risk or support amputation-related treatment decisions. A future amputation study would require separately ascertained events and follow-up, rather than relabelling non-healing as amputation. Prediction-model sample size also depends on outcome frequency and model complexity [28]. Equivalence requires a justified margin, not the smallest margin compatible with the observed data [29]; a margin is not a prerequisite for every association or discrimination analysis. The present contribution is an executable measurement audit, not a new topic-model algorithm or biological law. It quantifies the limits of equating mean loading with prevalence, conditional stability with full-pipeline robustness, or specimen contrasts with patient outcomes. Computational reproducibility makes those limits inspectable; independent patients and orthogonal measurements are needed to establish clinical value.

Table S1 fixes the role of each accession. Specimen counts, donor counts and cell counts answer different questions. The 54-sample source series is not the 25-sample frozen foot-skin subset, and neither is the 11-patient outcome subset. Cells in an external specimen are not independent replications of that specimen's clinical label.

Table S1. Cohort roles, analysis units and interpretation limits. GEO accessions identify the public source studies. Counts refer to specimens, mapped patients or donors as explicitly stated, rather than independent cells. DFU denotes diabetic foot ulcer and QC denotes quality control. The original discovery series, selected foot-skin representation and outcome subset have different denominators; external projections test construct associations or feasibility without a qualifying patient-level healing validation.

Cohort	Units	Role and limit
GSE165816	54 original specimens; 25 selected foot specimens	Discovery representation; 14 DFU specimens map to 11 outcome patients. The original series maps to 27 participants.
GSE231643	8 specimens	Title-derived healing labels (5, 3); no authoritative independent patient mapping.
GSE241132	3 donors; 12 timepoint samples	Healthy acute-wound construct audit; no DFU prognosis inference.
GSE223964	8 specimens	Frozen projection and exclusive immune-compartment audit; no qualifying healing outcome.
GSE245703	12 specimens	Frozen projection and immune-compartment audit; no qualifying healing outcome.
GSE268834	8 specimens	Descriptive diabetes-group and immune-context contrasts, not healing validation.
GSE248247	2 specimens; 358 QC cells	Low-yield projection check from 561 raw cells; correlations not estimated.

Discovery lineage scores average gene-wise standardized $\log(1 + 10^4 x_{ig} / \sum_h x_{ih})$ values within marker sets; the highest lineage score assigns the label. The fibroblast markers are COL1A1, COL1A2, PDGFRA, TWIST2, COL6A3, MMP2 and CCDC80. The circularity check concerns overlap with the tested topic's specified top-gene list; it does not imply independence from all genes contributing to the neural representation. The loading is a learned function of the full panel.

In external audits, immune assignment is PTPRC detection or detection of at least two markers within a T, NK, myeloid, B or plasma panel. These panels respectively contain CD3D, CD3E, CD2, TRBC1, TRBC2, NKG7, GNLY; LYZ, CD68, CD14, ITGAX, FCER1G, TYROBP, AIF1; MS4A1, CD79A, CD79B, BANK1; and MZB1, JCHAIN, DERL3, TNFRSF17. Fibroblast-like cells require at least two of COL1A1, COL1A2, COL3A1, DCN, LUM, PDGFRA, THY1 and no immune assignment. B/plasma cells are immune-assigned cells detecting at least one B or plasma marker. All remaining cells form the other compartment. Unlike the discovery lineage list, this external structural list includes topic-associated genes; it is a descriptive operational gate and is not evidence of gene-disjoint external validation.

The disjoint immune, fibroblast-like and other compartments sum to one. B/plasma is a subset of immune, so its within-immune share must not be added as a fourth exclusive compartment. The older overlapping marker-detection fractions are not used for the current external associations.

For distributional descriptions, pure high requires the sample's fibroblast 10th percentile to be at least 0.10; pure low requires its 90th percentile to be at most 0.15; mixed requires a 10th percentile at most 0.05 and a 90th percentile at least 0.40. Remaining samples are labelled other. These operational categories do not prove distinct biological attractors.

Let the reference and candidate k-nearest-neighbour graphs have component labels r_i, c_i. If n_{ab} counts cells jointly in reference component a and candidate component b, and $n_a = \sum_b n_{ab}$, the implementation computes reachability preservation exactly as

$$R_{\text{reach}} = \frac{\sum_{a,b} n_{ab}^2 - N}{\sum_a n_a^2 - N}, \tag{S1}$$

Equation (S1) is assigned value one when the denominator is zero. This sparse component-count calculation avoids materializing all pairwise reachability values. It is a connectivity statistic: two connected graphs can give one despite severely distorted local geometry. The separate edge-survival score is reported but is not included in the binary integrity condition.

Mean cell perplexity is $\overline{P} = N^{-1} \sum_i \exp[-\sum_k \theta_{ik} \log \theta_{ik}]$. The recorded integrity condition is $R_{\text{reach}} > 0.70$ and $\overline{P} \leq 0.95K$. A fixed 6,000-cell raw-count subset was permuted gene by gene across cells. This preserves each gene's observed value multiset but not row-wise library sizes; it raises $\overline{P}$ from 3.44 of 15 to 11.23 of 15 and lowers the mean HHI from 0.574 to 0.147. The shuffled input is therefore less concentrated and more structureless under this coordinate summary, but the experiment is not a complete technical null because library-size and detection-rate variation also narrow. It does not validate every topological feature or every cut at the fixed reachability bound. The K and state-cut grids in the main text do not constitute a sensitivity scan of the 0.70 connectivity bound.

Every interval names its resampling unit. The primary semantic bootstrap resamples the 20 mapped patients after fibroblast-count-weighted pooling; the earlier sample-row bootstrap remains a historical diagnostic, not the primary uncertainty estimate. The all-cell outcome bootstrap resamples patients within arms after replicate collapse. Historical pooled-fold AUC intervals resample fixed out-of-fold predictions; they do not refit the encoder or reproduce the entire learning algorithm on each bootstrap draw, and do not apply to the revised same-model held-pair estimand. Permutation inference reruns outcome-dependent score orientation and representation selection, which is why the appropriate null AUC need not be 0.5. The unadjusted $p = 0.0424$ for the sample-level module is exploratory across several readouts and is not a confirmatory multiplicity-controlled endpoint.

The next-study design calculation uses sample-derived arm spreads. This creates uncertainty not reflected by its Monte Carlo standard error; at estimated power 0.8 and 4,000 simulations, the conditional standard error is about $\sqrt{0.8(0.2)/4000} = 0.0063$. Candidate equivalence designs assume a true difference of zero. Bounded topic scores are approximated by Gaussian locations and variances, and proposed totals near 80% power are approximate search outputs rather than guaranteed minima.

For the exploratory AUC-design simulator, a unit-variance binormal score with class-mean separation d has AUC $= \Phi(d/\sqrt{2})$, hence $d = \sqrt{2}\Phi^{-1}(\text{AUC})$. Correlation is imposed on within-class noise, not on the full mean-shifted scores. Its standard-error approximation is estimated across simulated AUC differences; it is a model-based planning exercise, not a validated patient-level test. Neither these AUC calculations nor an intrapatient design-effect formula licenses treating repeated biopsies as independent prognosis cases.

Tables S2–S9 present the mapped patient scores, discrimination intervals, cross-method associations, conditional design calculations, semantic uncertainty and external immune-context summaries. Their denominators and limits accompany the values so that the three distinct readouts—all-cell mean, fibroblast mean and high-state fraction—remain identifiable. Tables S10 and S11 retain the complete covariate screen and immune/placebo residual summaries. Tables S12, S13, S14 and S15 distinguish the lineage, discrimination, paired-anatomy and equivalence estimands. Tables S18 and S17 retain every tested threshold and topic capacity, including adverse sensitivities. Table S7 records the exploratory AUC-gap simulation. The separate arithmetic conversion from specimens to patients under assumed intrapatient correlation is not a validated patient-prognosis design and is not used as a recruitment recommendation.

Table S2. Author-mapped GSE165816 DFU patient scores (7 healed, 4 not healed). Each score is the mean frozen fibroblast-associated topic loading over all retained cells in the listed foot specimens; pooling cells weights repeated specimens by retained cell count. Cells are counts, not independent outcome observations. Patient identifiers are study-derived pseudonyms and G labels identify specimens. The outcome is the source-study category within 12 weeks, not an individual healing day. Scores are on the topic-loading scale from zero to one.

Patient	Outcome	Specimens	Cells	All-cell mean
S01	not healed	G6	2279	0.0498
S02	healed	G23, G4	7495	0.1496
S03	healed	G2	3951	0.0185
S04	healed	G15	2250	0.0758
S05	not healed	G9	4290	0.0346
S06	not healed	G33, G34	7681	0.0103
S07	not healed	G39	2481	0.0277
S08	healed	G7, G8	4192	0.0754
S09	healed	G49	2928	0.0534
S10	healed	G42	1838	0.0167
S11	healed	G45	3374	0.0297

Table S3. Historical scoring diagnostics across 9 healing and 5 non-healing GSE165816 specimens. AUC is the area under the ROC curve for pooled leave-one-sample-out scores; higher values favour healing. The percentile 95% intervals use 4,000 arm-stratified resamples of fixed out-of-fold scores. One-sided permutation probabilities and null means rerun fold-dependent orientation and fitting. PCA is principal component analysis; NMF is nonnegative matrix factorization. Their raw coordinates are not calibrated across fitted folds, so these estimates cannot rank representations. The frozen topic encoder used discovery expression, and repeated patients limit independence. None of the six historical paired AUC-difference intervals excludes zero.

Readout	AUC	Bootstrap 95% interval	Permutation p	Null mean
Fibroblast topic	0.822	0.556 to 1.000	0.0604	0.562
Module	0.844	0.578 to 1.000	0.0424	0.497
PCA	0.533	0.156 to 0.889	0.4527	0.480
NMF	0.878	0.655 to 1.000	0.0597	0.553

Table S4. Historical patient-unit scoring diagnostics and paired anatomical sensitivity within GSE165816. The first four rows are pooled leave-one-patient-out AUCs for 7 healing and 4 non-healing patients, with 4,000 arm-stratified bootstrap draws of fixed scores and one-sided label-permutation probabilities. PCA and NMF denote principal component analysis and nonnegative matrix factorization; their coordinates are not comparable across fitted folds. These historical estimates are not uncertainty summaries for the revised held-pair procedure and do not rank representations. The final row is the foot-minus-forearm all-cell fibroblast-associated topic mean difference in 10 paired patients, with a 4,000-draw paired bootstrap interval and a two-sided exhaustive sign-flip probability using add-one correction. Its Benjamini–Hochberg q value across 15 topics is 0.0402. These row types have different estimands; neither supplies external validation.

Readout	Estimate	Bootstrap 95% interval	Permutation p
Fibroblast topic	0.7143	0.3571 to 1.0000	0.2991
Module	0.7857	0.5000 to 1.0000	0.1662
PCA	0.5000	0.0000 to 1.0000	0.5025
NMF	0.1250	0.0000 to 0.4286	0.9751
foot minus forearm	0.0476	0.0119 to 0.0916	0.0107

Table S5. Spearman correlations between the four representative sample-level prediction scores across the same 14 DFU specimens (9 healing, 5 non-healing). Fibroblast topic is the frozen all-cell loading, Module the specified fibro-inflammatory score, PCA principal component analysis and NMF nonnegative matrix factorization. Each row is one pair of readouts; values are descriptive point estimates without confidence intervals or multiplicity-adjusted tests. Related scores do not establish equivalent discrimination or rank methods.

Readout A	Readout B	Spearman correlation
Fibroblast topic	Module	0.7099
Fibroblast topic	PCA	0.1736
Fibroblast topic	NMF	0.6067
Module	PCA	0.4022
Module	NMF	0.6756
PCA	NMF	0.3200

Table S6. Conditional next-cohort simulations for all-cell fibroblast-associated topic mean loading. Rows assume hypothetical independent observations, no missing outcomes, healing allocation near 9/14, and arm SDs 0.05170 and 0.01686 estimated from deterministic discovery specimens. These descriptive spreads include repeated specimens and are not patient-population variance estimates. Two-sided Welch tests assess candidate mean differences; Welch two-one-sided tests assess equivalence under a true difference of zero, at alpha=0.05. Total and arm columns give the simulated observation counts; power uses 4,000 draws per candidate size. Values near 0.80 have Monte Carlo error and are approximate search outputs. Candidate differences and margins are inputs, not clinical minimum important differences or validated recruitment targets.

Design	Difference / margin	Total	Healing / other	Estimated power
Detect difference	0.02	100	64 / 36	0.797
Detect difference	0.03	47	30 / 17	0.821
Detect difference	0.0457	21	14 / 7	0.811
Detect difference	0.06	14	9 / 5	0.804
Detect difference	0.08	9	6 / 3	0.807
Detect difference	0.1	8	5 / 3	0.880
Equivalence under zero difference	0.02	110	71 / 39	0.815
Equivalence under zero difference	0.03	49	32 / 17	0.826
Equivalence under zero difference	0.05	20	13 / 7	0.830
Equivalence under zero difference	0.075	11	7 / 4	0.880
Equivalence under zero difference	0.1	8	5 / 3	0.915

Table S7. Exploratory binormal planning simulation for paired AUC differences. Two candidate AUCs are centred on 0.80, separated by the stated gap, with within-class score-noise correlation 0.5045 and healing allocation near 9/14. Each searched total uses 4,000 simulation draws and a model-based normal approximation for the paired difference at alpha=0.05. Totals assume one observation per independent patient and no missing outcome. The gaps are hypothetical inputs; the approximate 80% power search does not establish actual clinical performance, calibrated patient-test power or a validated recruitment target.

Candidate AUC gap	Total observations	Healing / non-healing	Estimated power
0.05	706	454 / 252	0.800
0.1	181	116 / 65	0.814
0.15	85	55 / 30	0.797
0.2	50	32 / 18	0.800

Table S8. Association between mean fibroblast-associated topic loading within fibroblasts and the threshold-defined high-state fraction across 25 GSE165816 specimens. The Spearman row gives the observed correlation and percentile 95% limits from 10,000 sample-row bootstrap draws. The leave-one-out row gives the minimum and maximum of 25 recalculations, not a confidence interval; a dash means no single point estimate applies. A separate 10,000-draw permutation analysis gave a two-sided add-one probability of 0.00010 and a central null interval from -0.4025 to 0.4072. Samples may share patients, and the two summaries share cells.

Summary	Estimate	Lower endpoint	Upper endpoint
spearman rho	0.9325	0.7887	0.9828
leave one out rho	—	0.9235	0.9566

Table S9. External sample-level Spearman correlations with the frozen fibroblast-associated topic mean under exclusive lineage gates. Immune fraction divides immune-assigned cells by all retained cells; B/plasma share divides B/plasma cells by immune-assigned cells. Detected genes and unique molecular identifiers (UMIs) are separate per-sample medians over QC cells. All entries are descriptive point estimates without confidence intervals. Specimens are not verified independent patients, and no listed cohort supplies a qualifying patient-level healing outcome.

Cohort	Samples	Immune fraction	B/plasma share	Detected genes	UMIs
GSE223964	8	-0.024	-0.071	-0.429	-0.476
GSE245703	12	0.846	0.077	-0.427	-0.308
GSE268834	8	0.714	-0.500	0.238	0.262

Table S10. Complete exploratory covariate screen in 25 discovery specimens. Each row correlates the fibroblast high-state fraction, using the historical rule loading at least 0.184, with one of 31 covariates. Lineage fractions use all retained cells; technical summaries and topic means use fibroblasts. Values are Spearman rho, two-sided asymptotic p and Benjamini–Hochberg q across all 31 tests, ordered by absolute rho; 14 rows have q below 0.05. UMI means unique molecular identifier. The G label is an identifier, not an established batch or time variable. Repeated patients invalidate the naive independent-row premise of these historical p values; their BH transforms do not establish false-discovery-rate control or 14 independent discoveries. Shared cells and compositional constraints further limit interpretation; these are descriptive row-level summaries, not causal or healing-validation tests.

Covariate	Specimens	Spearman rho	Raw p	BH q
B/plasma fraction	25	0.8279	3.26e-07	1.01e-05
Fibroblast CFD/APOD mean	25	-0.7664	7.95e-06	0.000123
Fibroblast PTPRC-positive fraction	25	0.7267	3.88e-05	0.000401
Fibroblast median UMI count	25	0.6632	0.000302	0.00234
Fibroblast IGFBP7/TAGLN mean	25	0.6514	0.000421	0.00261
Sweat-gland fraction	25	-0.5832	0.00222	0.0114
Fibroblast FOS/IGFBP7 mean	25	-0.5687	0.00302	0.0134
Fibroblast DCN/CFD mean	25	-0.5592	0.00366	0.0142
Fibroblast IGFBP7/IGFBP5 mean	25	0.5316	0.00624	0.0215
Fibroblast COL1A1/COL1A2 mean	25	0.5238	0.00721	0.0223
Keratinocyte fraction	25	-0.4836	0.0143	0.0404
Fibroblast HLA-DRA/CD74 mean	25	0.4726	0.0171	0.0441
T-cell fraction	25	0.4647	0.0193	0.0459
Fibroblast TAGLN/ACTA2 mean	25	0.4552	0.0222	0.0492
Melanocyte fraction	25	-0.4442	0.0261	0.054
Fibroblast JUNB/DNAJB1 mean	25	0.4182	0.0375	0.0726
Mast-cell fraction	25	-0.3977	0.0489	0.0893
Myeloid fraction	25	0.3891	0.0546	0.094
Numeric G specimen label	25	-0.3607	0.0765	0.125
Endothelial fraction	25	-0.2347	0.259	0.401
Total retained cells	25	-0.2276	0.274	0.404
Fibroblast DNAJB1/FOS mean	25	0.1977	0.344	0.484
Fibroblast KRT14/KRT10 mean	25	0.1457	0.487	0.63
Fibroblast dissociation score	25	0.1449	0.489	0.63
Lymphatic endothelial fraction	25	-0.1331	0.526	0.63
Fibroblast fraction	25	0.1292	0.538	0.63
Fibroblast FOS/JUNB mean	25	-0.1260	0.548	0.63
Retained fibroblasts	25	0.0851	0.686	0.759
Pericyte/smooth-muscle fraction	25	-0.0473	0.823	0.879
Fibroblast IGFBP7/SPARCL1 mean	25	-0.0354	0.866	0.895
Fibroblast DCD/SAT1 mean	25	-0.0236	0.911	0.911

Table S11. Immune-transcript exclusion and residual-mixture controls. BIC denotes Bayesian information criterion, fitted to sample high-state fractions or their regression residuals; the difference is BIC for one Gaussian minus BIC for two. Positive differences favour two components. The first two rows share 24 matched specimens and have fraction correlation 0.9887. Residual regressions use all 25 specimens: immune covariates are B/plasma, T-cell and myeloid fractions plus immune-transcript positivity; placebos are pericyte/smooth-muscle, endothelial, melanocyte and sweat-gland fractions. R squared is variance explained by each regression and is inapplicable to unadjusted rows (dash). Both residual differences are negative, so the analysis does not establish immune-specific separation.

Summary	n	R squared	BIC one	BIC two	Difference
Before immune-transcript exclusion	24	—	12.417	-28.569	40.986
After immune-transcript exclusion	24	—	5.342	-51.341	56.683
Immune-covariate residuals	25	0.4953	-3.900	0.031	-3.931
Placebo-covariate residuals	25	0.3549	2.235	10.433	-8.198

Table S12. Historical sample-level lineage and loading contrasts. Ratios divide the healing-arm mean by the non-healing-arm mean; intervals are percentile 95% limits from 20,000 within-arm sample bootstraps, and p values are two-sided Mann–Whitney tests. GSE165816 uses 9 versus 5 DFU specimens; GSE231643 uses 5 versus 3 title-labelled specimens. The discovery ratios come from the saved lineage-projection analysis and are distinct from the later deterministic all-cell patient contrast. Fibroblast fraction uses all cells as denominator; fibroblast mean uses only assigned fibroblasts. These are separate estimands. Repeated discovery patients and unavailable external patient mappings prevent independent outcome validation.

Cohort	Readout	Mean ratio	Bootstrap 95% interval	Raw p
GSE165816	Fibroblast fraction	1.425	0.873 to 2.298	0.438
GSE165816	All-cell topic mean	2.724	1.369 to 5.732	0.0599
GSE165816	Within-fibroblast topic mean	2.889	1.059 to 13.966	0.042
GSE231643	Fibroblast fraction	2.051	1.128 to 4.184	0.0714
GSE231643	All-cell topic mean	2.564	1.310 to 8.079	0.143
GSE231643	Within-fibroblast topic mean	1.660	1.007 to 6.102	0.143

Table S13. Historical paired AUC differences for the pooled-fold scoring procedure at each analysis unit. Each contrast subtracts the second leave-one-out readout from the first. Percentile 95% intervals use 4,000 common-index, arm-stratified bootstrap draws of fixed out-of-fold scores: 9 versus 5 specimens or 7 versus 4 mapped patients. PCA and NMF denote principal component analysis and nonnegative matrix factorization. No sample-unit interval excludes zero; patient-unit Fibroblast topic minus NMF and Module minus NMF intervals do. Because raw PCA/NMF coordinates can change between fitted folds, neither exclusion from zero supports representation superiority. These historical intervals are unadjusted, omit refitting uncertainty and do not describe the revised within-model held-pair estimand.

Unit	AUC contrast	Difference	Bootstrap 95% interval
14 specimens	Fibroblast topic minus Module	-0.0222	-0.2889 to 0.2222
14 specimens	Fibroblast topic minus PCA	0.2889	-0.0889 to 0.6667
14 specimens	Fibroblast topic minus NMF	-0.0556	-0.3556 to 0.2222
14 specimens	Module minus PCA	0.3111	0.0000 to 0.6667
14 specimens	Module minus NMF	-0.0333	-0.2889 to 0.2000
14 specimens	PCA minus NMF	-0.3444	-0.7111 to 0.0000
11 patients	Fibroblast topic minus Module	-0.0714	-0.4286 to 0.2857
11 patients	Fibroblast topic minus PCA	0.2143	-0.4643 to 0.9286
11 patients	Fibroblast topic minus NMF	0.5893	0.1429 to 0.9643
11 patients	Module minus PCA	0.2857	-0.1786 to 0.7857
11 patients	Module minus NMF	0.6607	0.2857 to 0.9652
11 patients	PCA minus NMF	0.3750	0.0000 to 0.7857

Table S14. Complete paired anatomical control across 15 topics in 10 author-mapped patients. Differences are mean all-cell loadings in foot minus forearm, after cell-count-weighted collapse of repeated foot specimens. Intervals are percentile 95% limits from 4,000 paired-patient bootstrap draws. Two-sided p values enumerate all 1,024 sign allocations and retain add-one correction; q values use Benjamini–Hochberg across 15 topics. The TIMP1/COL3A1, COL1A1/COL1A2, CFD/APOD and IGFBP7/TAGLN loadings have q below 0.05. Labels list the two leading decoder genes; they do not assert cell-type identity. Bootstrap intervals and permutation tests need not be dual. This is an anatomical sensitivity control within the discovery source, not a healing endpoint.

Leading genes	Foot minus forearm	Bootstrap 95% interval	Sign-flip p	BH q
TIMP1/COL3A1	0.0476	0.0119 to 0.0916	0.0107	0.0402
JUNB/DNAJB1	0.0103	-0.0616 to 0.0793	0.799	0.956
COL1A1/COL1A2	0.0914	0.0535 to 0.1376	0.00293	0.022
IGFBP7/IGFBP5	0.0188	0.0041 to 0.0361	0.0634	0.119
TAGLN/ACTA2	0.0016	-0.0200 to 0.0241	0.893	0.956
KRT14/KRT10	-0.2491	-0.4274 to -0.0682	0.0361	0.0774
CFD/APOD	-0.0362	-0.0567 to -0.0169	0.0107	0.0402
DCN/CFD	-0.0159	-0.0383 to 0.0042	0.208	0.312
DCD/SAT1	-0.0001	-0.0083 to 0.0098	0.975	0.975
IGFBP7/SPARCL1	0.0398	-0.0015 to 0.0897	0.134	0.223
FOS/IGFBP7	-0.0038	-0.0087 to 0.0025	0.245	0.334

Table S14 (continued)

Leading genes	Foot minus forearm	Bootstrap 95% interval	Sign-flip p	BH q
HLA-DRA/CD74	0.0111	-0.0591 to 0.0984	0.854	0.956
IGFBP7/TAGLN	0.0715	0.0436 to 0.1039	0.00293	0.022
FOS/JUNB	0.0068	0.0025 to 0.0118	0.0185	0.0556
DNAJB1/FOS	0.0061	0.0020 to 0.0108	0.0224	0.0561

Table S15. Complete Welch two-one-sided-test sensitivity grids for the all-cell mean fibroblast-associated topic contrast. The symmetric margin is on the loading scale, and both lower and upper one-sided p values must be below 0.05 for the final column to be Yes. Sample rows use 9 versus 5 specimens; patient rows use 7 versus 4 mapped patients with cell-count-weighted repeat collapse. Margins were examined retrospectively and have no externally justified clinical meaning. A Yes entry therefore records a mathematical sensitivity result, not demonstrated clinical equivalence.

Unit	Margin	Lower-test p	Upper-test p	Both below 0.05
14 specimens	0.05	0.000198	0.413	No
14 specimens	0.10	5.59e-06	0.0077	Yes
14 specimens	0.20	3.66e-08	3.31e-06	Yes
14 specimens	0.30	1.14e-09	2.6e-08	Yes
14 specimens	0.50	9.95e-12	6.75e-11	Yes
11 patients	0.05	0.00172	0.159	No
11 patients	0.10	7.56e-05	0.00323	Yes
11 patients	0.20	1.09e-06	1.02e-05	Yes
11 patients	0.30	6.42e-08	3e-07	Yes
11 patients	0.50	1.45e-09	3.72e-09	Yes

Table S16. Patient-level robustness in the discovery cohort. The first row correlates fibroblast mean loading with the high-state fraction after weighting repeated specimen summaries by fibroblast count within 20 patients (25 specimens). Its percentile 95% interval uses 10,000 patient resamples, seed 217. The second row uses the previously defined all-cell healing contrast in 7 healing and 4 non-healing patients; its original interval remains in the outcome table. Omission ranges give the minimum and maximum after deleting one patient at a time (20 or 11 omissions), not confidence limits. Neither analysis refits the expression model, changes the state cut, adds patients, or provides external validation.

Quantity	Unit	Estimate	Patient bootstrap 95%	Patient-omission range
Mean versus high-state fraction	20 patients	0.9372	0.7760 to 0.9903	0.9266 to 0.9643
Healing minus non-healing	11 patients	0.0293	Not recalculated	0.0143 to 0.0365

Table S17. Topic-capacity sensitivity after tracking the TIMP1-carrying topic at each K. Gene-based descriptions identify the tracked loading; each fit supplies its own two-Gaussian midpoint cut. Semantic rho uses 25 specimens; the unadjusted healing-arm p value uses 9 versus 5 high-state-fraction summaries. The final column asks whether the maximum fraction occurs in healthy skin. At K=10 the tracked topic is a different IGFBP-rich programme and the counterexample fails. Topics across capacities are not assumed to have identical biological meaning.

K	Programme description	Derived cut	Semantic rho	Healing p	Healthy maximum
10	IGFBP-rich	0.1454	0.9469	0.147	No
15	CHI3L1/COL3A1-rich	0.1691	0.9316	0.109	Yes
20	CHI3L1/COL3A1-rich	0.1695	0.9236	0.109	Yes

Table S18. All 18 state-cut sensitivity evaluations for the frozen K=15 topic. Spearman rho correlates fibroblast mean loading with the threshold-defined high-state fraction across 25 specimens. The ratio compares mean high-state fractions in 9 healing versus 5 non-healing specimens; p is the unadjusted two-sided Mann–Whitney probability. The last column gives the group containing the largest fraction. The grid includes the fitted cut rounded to 0.1843. Four cuts have p below 0.05; these are dependent sensitivity analyses, not 18 independent confirmations.

State cut	Semantic rho	Healing / non-healing	Raw p	Largest fraction
0.0800	0.9326	2.966	0.042	Healthy
0.1000	0.9414	2.959	0.042	Healthy
0.1200	0.9091	3.011	0.042	Healthy
0.1400	0.9301	2.992	0.042	Healthy
0.1600	0.9294	2.981	0.0599	Healthy
0.1800	0.9349	3.001	0.0599	Healthy
0.1843	0.9325	2.975	0.0599	Healthy
0.2000	0.9349	2.987	0.0599	Healthy
0.2200	0.9341	3.124	0.0599	Healthy
0.2400	0.9228	3.352	0.0617	Healthy
0.2600	0.9228	3.424	0.0617	Healthy
0.2800	0.9236	3.465	0.0617	Healthy

Table S18 (continued)

State cut	Semantic rho	Healing / non-healing	Raw p	Largest fraction
0.3000	0.9236	3.499	0.0617	Healthy
0.3200	0.9479	3.741	0.0617	Healthy
0.3400	0.9463	3.699	0.0617	Healthy
0.3600	0.9401	4.040	0.0608	Healthy
0.3800	0.9182	3.945	0.0608	Healthy
0.4000	0.9182	3.889	0.0608	Healthy

Table S19. Exact mean decomposition on the saved 19,410 discovery fibroblasts in 25 specimens. The cut is 0.184295848; empirical bin means are distinct from fitted Gaussian-component means. The constant-state approximation uses the cell-pooled low/high means, and its residual is the observed specimen mean minus that approximation. RMS denotes root-mean-square residual with equal specimen weights. Ranges exclude undefined means for empty bins; zero-weight terms contribute zero to the identity. Both exact identities have maximum numerical discrepancy below 10^{-15}. Values are on the zero-to-one loading scale, apart from the count row. They describe the frozen sample, without confidence intervals, a test of invariant state intensity or causal variance attribution.

Quantity	Value or range	Denominator
Cell-pooled low-bin mean	0.02380	All 19,410 fibroblasts
Cell-pooled high-bin mean	0.51301	All 19,410 fibroblasts
Specimen low-bin means	0.01204 to 0.10213	25 nonempty low bins
Specimen high-bin means	0.22645 to 0.57777	16 nonempty high bins
Specimens with an empty bin	9	9 of 25; high bin empty
Within-state residual range	-0.02434 to 0.04377	All 25 specimens
Within-state residual RMS	0.01575	Equal specimen weights

Table S20. Independent arithmetic check of the all-cell mean-loading contrast in 11 patients (7 healing, 4 non-healing). Exhaustive allocation includes the observed labels and numerical ties: 90/330 allocations are at least as extreme in absolute mean difference, whereas the retained add-one convention gives 91/331. These probabilities assume observational label exchangeability and do not identify a causal effect. Welch quantities use sample variances within the two outcome groups. Standard error, interval and margin are on the loading scale; degrees of freedom and probabilities are dimensionless. A margin strictly greater than the infimum would be needed to reject both one-sided tests at 0.05. The data-derived boundary is not a clinical equivalence margin.

Quantity	Value
All label allocations	330
At least as extreme as observed	90
Exhaustive two-sided probability	0.272727
Recorded add-one probability	0.274924
Welch standard error	0.019446
Welch degrees of freedom	8.113833
Two-sided 90% Welch interval	-0.006816 to 0.065375
Equivalence-margin infimum	0.065375

Table S21. Observed-cell extension: mapped patient-level tissue measurements from 25 selected foot specimens. Patient labels are stable pseudonyms within this extension. The 20 rows include 9 non-diabetic participants, who do not enter healing tests, and 11 DFU patients (7 healed and 4 not healed). Repeated specimens are pooled by fibroblast count for the mean and high-state fraction, and by all-cell count for fibroblast composition. High state uses the unchanged discovery midpoint. Specimens and fibroblasts are counts; the three readouts are unitless fractions or loadings on zero-to-one scales.

Patient	Group	Specimens	Fibroblasts	Fibroblast mean	High fraction	Fibroblast fraction
01	Not healed	1	221	0.2496	0.5113	0.0970
02	Healed	2	2751	0.3473	0.5863	0.3670
03	Healed	1	1238	0.0274	0.0226	0.3133
04	Healed	1	356	0.3521	0.6994	0.1582
05	Not healed	1	843	0.0125	0.0000	0.1965
06	Not healed	2	1552	0.0179	0.0032	0.2021
07	Not healed	1	872	0.0547	0.0837	0.3515
08	Healed	2	1605	0.1648	0.2960	0.3829
09	Healed	1	363	0.2087	0.3719	0.1240
10	Healed	1	170	0.0705	0.0824	0.0925
11	Healed	1	1821	0.0393	0.0483	0.5397
12	Non-diabetic	1	1020	0.4663	0.8412	0.3491
13	Non-diabetic	1	215	0.0295	0.0186	0.0866
14	Non-diabetic	2	1921	0.0137	0.0000	0.2509
15	Non-diabetic	1	1152	0.0120	0.0000	0.3904
16	Non-diabetic	2	1562	0.0153	0.0000	0.1873
17	Non-diabetic	1	153	0.0136	0.0000	0.1939

Table S21 (continued)

Patient	Group	Specimens	Fibroblasts	Fibroblast mean	High fraction	Fibroblast fraction
18	Non-diabetic	1	974	0.0131	0.0010	0.1804
19	Non-diabetic	1	425	0.0135	0.0000	0.2941
20	Non-diabetic	1	196	0.0205	0.0000	0.1142

Table S22. Patient-unit extension of the three fibroblast readouts. Differences are healed minus not healed in the same 7 and 4 DFU patients. Percentile intervals use 10,000 within-arm patient resamples, seed 17. Exact two-sided probabilities enumerate all 330 label allocations including ties, without add-one correction; q values apply Benjamini–Hochberg adjustment to the three readouts within each weighting variant. These are retrospective observational comparisons without a clinical equivalence margin. Every DFU specimen already has at least 100 fibroblasts, so the 100-cell eligibility variant reproduces the pooled-cell comparison exactly and duplicate rows are omitted. Repeated-cell and specimen weighting affect only aggregation within a patient.

Aggregation	Readout	Difference	Bootstrap 95% interval	Exact p	BH q
Pooled cells	Fibroblast mean	0.0892	-0.0486 to 0.2177	0.3121	0.4697
Pooled cells	High-state fraction	0.1514	-0.1331 to 0.4153	0.3697	0.4697
Pooled cells	Fibroblast composition	0.0708	-0.0708 to 0.2146	0.4697	0.4697
Equal specimens	Fibroblast mean	0.0974	-0.0421 to 0.2260	0.2788	0.4848
Equal specimens	High-state fraction	0.1683	-0.1170 to 0.4310	0.3424	0.4848
Equal specimens	Fibroblast composition	0.0679	-0.0724 to 0.2114	0.4848	0.4848

Table S23. Patient-level threshold sensitivity in the same 7 healed and 4 non-healed DFU patients. Each patient has equal group weight; recovered fibroblasts are pooled within patient. Differences are healed minus non-healed high-state fractions. Exact two-sided p values enumerate all 330 patient-label allocations, including ties, without add-one correction. The support-wide p compares each absolute contrast with the maximum absolute patient-group CDF difference over every distinct observed loading in each allocation; it accounts for searching across that complete support under the exchangeability null. The threshold-free maximum is 0.3045 with exact p=0.1848. Original denotes the unchanged fitted midpoint. These retrospective diagnostics are not independent validation.

Threshold	Original	Difference	Exact p	Support-wide p
0.0500	False	0.2485	0.2242	0.3182
0.1000	False	0.1958	0.3030	0.4515
0.1500	False	0.1682	0.3424	0.5606
0.1843	True	0.1514	0.3697	0.6152
0.2000	False	0.1445	0.3727	0.6424
0.3000	False	0.1300	0.3727	0.7182
0.4000	False	0.1029	0.3909	0.8061
0.5000	False	0.0819	0.3667	0.8758
0.6000	False	0.0570	0.3091	0.9485

Table S24. Cell-count and repeated-specimen sensitivity at the fixed original threshold. Equal-cell rows use 250 draws of 100 fibroblasts without replacement from each DFU specimen, seed 29, followed by equal specimen weighting within each patient. The other rows enumerate every one-specimen-per-patient choice across the three repeated patients. Every comparison retains 7 healed and 4 non-healed patients and recomputes the exact 330-allocation probability. Difference ranges are healed minus non-healed; positive counts cover the listed number of comparisons. Neither range is a confidence interval. Composition is omitted from equal-fibroblast sampling because that selected subset no longer estimates the original all-cell denominator.

Sensitivity	Readout	Comparisons	Difference range	Exact p range	Positive
100 cells per specimen	Fibroblast mean	250	0.0749 to 0.1233	0.1273 to 0.3879	250/250
100 cells per specimen	High-state fraction	250	0.1098 to 0.2229	0.1515 to 0.5667	250/250
One specimen per patient	Fibroblast mean	8	0.0777 to 0.1170	0.2333 to 0.3303	8/8
One specimen per patient	High-state fraction	8	0.1284 to 0.2081	0.2667 to 0.4394	8/8
One specimen per patient	Fibroblast composition	8	0.0440 to 0.0918	0.3909 to 0.6515	8/8

Table S25. Raw-count column-shuffle control on 6,000 cells, with 240 cells sampled from each of 25 specimens. Every one of 23,572 gene-value multisets is preserved exactly before normalization. Both branches use the same frozen encoder and deterministic projection. HHI is the sum of squared topic proportions; lower HHI and higher perplexity describe reduced concentration. Library sizes and detected-gene counts use all source genes. Detection fraction divides the detected-gene count by 23,572. Means are preserved by column marginals, but row-wise variation narrows. These descriptive values neither isolate biological co-expression from technical row structure nor show rejection by the historical integrity gate.

Quantity	Original counts	Shuffled counts
Mean topic perplexity	3.4383	11.2306
Mean HHI	0.5740	0.1467

Table S25 (continued)

Quantity	Original counts	Shuffled counts
Library size, mean	9275.2065	9275.2065
Library size, SD	10907.9970	1500.9520
Detected genes, mean	2312.1958	2312.1958
Detected genes, SD	1367.1079	38.9770
Detection fraction, mean	0.0981	0.0981
Detection fraction, SD	0.0580	0.0017

Table S26. Marker-reference sensitivity in 11 DFU patients. Re-estimating marker means and SDs within each specimen changes 7,044 of 76,461 cell labels (9.21%); fibroblast calls change from 19,410 to 19,711, with 1,119 lost and 1,420 gained. The maximum specimen changes are 0.0371 for the fibroblast mean and 0.0695 for high-state fraction. Listed differences are healed minus non-healed after count-weighted patient aggregation; exact probabilities enumerate 330 allocations, and BH q adjusts the three readouts within each gate. Applying the frozen pooled reference per specimen reproduces all original labels and is omitted as a duplicate implementation check. No independent cell-identity truth set selects the correct gate.

Marker reference	Readout	Difference	Exact p	BH q
Pooled reference	Fibroblast mean	0.0892	0.3121	0.4697
Pooled reference	High-state fraction	0.1514	0.3697	0.4697
Pooled reference	Fibroblast composition	0.0708	0.4697	0.4697
Per-specimen reference	Fibroblast mean	0.0887	0.3182	0.4970
Per-specimen reference	High-state fraction	0.1558	0.3667	0.4970
Per-specimen reference	Fibroblast composition	0.0553	0.4970	0.4970

Table S27. Secondary DFU-only specimen-label calibration. All 11 healthy specimens are excluded before enumerating the 2,002 allocations of 9 healed and 5 non-healed specimen labels. Differences are equal-specimen arm means, healed minus non-healed. The central 95% null interval describes the allocation distribution and is not an effect confidence interval. Exact two-sided probabilities include the observed allocation and ties without add-one correction. Repeated specimens share patients, so the 11-patient comparisons remain primary.

Readout	Difference	Central null 95%	Exact p
Fibroblast mean	0.1335	-0.1652 to 0.1623	0.0894
High-state fraction	0.2380	-0.3167 to 0.3222	0.1199
Fibroblast composition	0.0888	-0.1540 to 0.1460	0.2697

Table S28. Disagreement between five repeated-specimen pairs from five patients, including three DFU patients. G labels retain source specimen identifiers. Mean and high-fraction differences are absolute, using fibroblast-restricted summaries and the unchanged threshold. The split-half column lists the 97.5th percentile of absolute mean differences from 250 random disjoint fibroblast partitions within each specimen, in pair order. The empirical CDF supremum compares the two full loading distributions. Cell partitions describe conditional finite-cell variability; they are not biological replicates, confidence intervals, a patient-level null, an intraclass correlation or clinical reliability estimates.

Specimens	Group	Mean difference	Split-half limits	High-fraction diff.	CDF supremum
G23 / G4	Healed	0.0096	0.0309 / 0.0445	0.0025	0.0576
G33 / G34	Not healed	0.0042	0.0017 / 0.0041	0.0053	0.1251
G7 / G8	Healed	0.2583	0.0553 / 0.0185	0.5458	0.5789
G31 / G32	Non-diabetic	0.0002	0.0007 / 0.0009	0.0000	0.0337
G10 / G24	Non-diabetic	0.0019	0.0010 / 0.0013	0.0000	0.1865

Table S29. Revised same-model held-pair discrimination in 11 mapped DFU patients (7 healing, 4 non-healing). Each of the 28 folds holds one patient from each arm out, fits on the other nine and scores both with one unchanged rule. Wins favour the healing patient; an exact tie earns one-half credit. Discrimination is total credit divided by 28, not a pooled-fold raw-coordinate AUC. Topic and module orientation and PCA/NMF fitting and component selection use training patients. NMF basis normalization and training-SD-standardized component selection remove positive scaling ambiguity. The uniform NMF cap was raised from 1,000 to 10,000 after training-convergence warnings; no final fit warned. All pairs share 11 patients, and discovery expression informed the fixed panel and encoder. No confidence intervals, p values, independent validation or representation ranking are claimed.

Readout	Wins	Ties	Losses	Pair credit	Discrimination
Frozen topic	20	0	8	20.0 / 28	0.7143
Module	22	0	6	22.0 / 28	0.7857
PCA	14	0	14	14.0 / 28	0.5000
NMF	5	3	20	6.5 / 28	0.2321

Table S30. Full released-count depth audit of all 81,602 pre-analysis-QC columns from 25 foot-skin specimens. Baseline reproduces 76,461 retained cells and 19,410 fibroblast labels. Each nonzero count is independently binomial-thinned at the stated probability; each rate starts from original counts and uses all three fixed computational seeds. QC is at least 200 detected genes and mitochondrial fraction at most 0.20. Marker means/SDs, forced-winner gate, encoder and high-state cut remain frozen. Lost and gained cells are relative to baseline QC, not a net count. Lineage switches divide changed labels by cells surviving both QC passes. Zero-marker cells pass QC but detect none of the annotation markers; their forced labels are not independently validated. Counts are cells, not independent subjects; seeds provide no biological replication.

Count retention	Seed	QC cells	Lost / gained	Lineage switches	Zero-marker cells
100%	Baseline	76461	0 / 0	0.00%	92
75%	20260925	76375	127 / 41	3.18%	165
75%	20260926	76387	113 / 39	3.30%	169
75%	20260927	76393	117 / 49	3.29%	168
50%	20260925	75738	793 / 70	6.23%	384
50%	20260926	75726	799 / 64	6.25%	363
50%	20260927	75724	810 / 73	6.34%	386
25%	20260925	72145	4419 / 103	10.29%	770
25%	20260926	72197	4367 / 103	10.48%	842
25%	20260927	72145	4404 / 88	10.45%	815
10%	20260925	61397	15175 / 111	15.36%	1429
10%	20260926	61366	15210 / 115	15.40%	1462
10%	20260927	61395	15178 / 112	15.31%	1410

Table S31. Patient contrasts after rerunning QC and the frozen-reference gate on each depth perturbation. Differences are healed minus non-healed, with seven and four author-mapped DFU patients. Repeated specimens are pooled by the appropriate all-cell or fibroblast count. Fibroblast composition uses all current QC survivors; high state uses the unchanged discovery cut. The exact two-sided probability enumerates all 330 patient-label allocations, including ties, without add-one correction. Baseline has one run; other rows give the minimum and maximum over three fixed thinning seeds. These are computational ranges, not confidence intervals, multiplicity-adjusted discoveries, equivalence bounds or biological replication. Zero-panel cells remain explicitly missing in conditional branches rather than receiving scores from an all-zero vector.

Count retention	Readout	Estimable runs	Difference range	Exact p range
100%	All-cell mean	1 / 1	0.0293 to 0.0293	0.2727 to 0.2727
100%	Fibroblast mean	1 / 1	0.0892 to 0.0892	0.3121 to 0.3121
100%	High-state fraction	1 / 1	0.1514 to 0.1514	0.3697 to 0.3697
100%	Fibroblast composition	1 / 1	0.0708 to 0.0708	0.4697 to 0.4697
75%	All-cell mean	3 / 3	0.0291 to 0.0292	0.2758 to 0.2818
75%	Fibroblast mean	3 / 3	0.0876 to 0.0899	0.2970 to 0.3182
75%	High-state fraction	3 / 3	0.1451 to 0.1518	0.3545 to 0.3788
75%	Fibroblast composition	3 / 3	0.0687 to 0.0706	0.4727 to 0.4788
50%	All-cell mean	3 / 3	0.0289 to 0.0291	0.2818 to 0.2848
50%	Fibroblast mean	3 / 3	0.0880 to 0.0913	0.2848 to 0.3152
50%	High-state fraction	3 / 3	0.1485 to 0.1620	0.3364 to 0.3727
50%	Fibroblast composition	3 / 3	0.0683 to 0.0698	0.4758 to 0.4848
25%	All-cell mean	3 / 3	0.0292 to 0.0293	0.2788 to 0.2879
25%	Fibroblast mean	3 / 3	0.0883 to 0.0902	0.2758 to 0.2758
25%	High-state fraction	3 / 3	0.1526 to 0.1634	0.3303 to 0.3424
25%	Fibroblast composition	3 / 3	0.0737 to 0.0759	0.4455 to 0.4727
10%	All-cell mean	3 / 3	0.0288 to 0.0296	0.3303 to 0.3455
10%	Fibroblast mean	3 / 3	0.0879 to 0.0918	0.1970 to 0.2212
10%	High-state fraction	3 / 3	0.1645 to 0.1687	0.2515 to 0.3000
10%	Fibroblast composition	3 / 3	0.0845 to 0.0897	0.3636 to 0.4091

Table S32. Complete descriptive covariate update in 20 author-mapped discovery patients. Every row correlates the patient fibroblast high-score fraction with one of the original 31 covariates, using current deterministic coordinates and the fitted cut 0.184295848. Fibroblast means/fractions pool fibroblast cells; lineage fractions pool counts with all cells as denominator, and count covariates sum. Technical scores average saved specimen summaries with fibroblast-count weights; weighted specimen UMI medians are not a pooled-patient median. G labels are averaged within patient and do not identify a verified batch. Rows retain the full covariate family; none is selected by significance. The deletion range recomputes rho after each of 20 patient omissions and is not a confidence interval. The last column counts deletions whose correlation sign differs from the full estimate. No p values, BH discoveries or adjusted associations are supplied. Mixed clinical groups, shared cells and compositional dependence prevent causal attribution or independent validation.

Covariate	Patients	Spearman rho	Patient-deletion range	Sign changes
Fibroblast JUNB/DNAJB1 mean	20	0.5055	0.4480 to 0.5901	0
Fibroblast FOS/IGFBP7 mean	20	-0.4732	-0.5604 to -0.4084	0
Fibroblast HLA-DRA/CD74 mean	20	0.4978	0.4390 to 0.5684	0
Fibroblast IGFBP7/TAGLN mean	20	0.7145	0.6905 to 0.7502	0
Fibroblast FOS/JUNB mean	20	0.0077	-0.0882 to 0.1511	9
Fibroblast DNAJB1/FOS mean	20	0.3073	0.2388 to 0.4589	0

Table S32 (continued)

Covariate	Patients	Spearman rho	Patient-deletion range	Sign changes
Fibroblast COL1A1/COL1A2 mean	20	0.5024	0.4464 to 0.6415	0
Fibroblast IGFBP7/IGFBP5 mean	20	0.5055	0.4588 to 0.6981	0
Fibroblast TAGLN/ACTA2 mean	20	0.5608	0.4858 to 0.6566	0
Fibroblast KRT14/KRT10 mean	20	0.1367	0.0543 to 0.2611	0
Fibroblast CFD/APOD mean	20	-0.7652	-0.7916 to -0.7251	0
Fibroblast DCN/CFD mean	20	-0.6146	-0.7181 to -0.5487	0
Fibroblast DCD/SAT1 mean	20	-0.0323	-0.1212 to 0.0740	4
Fibroblast IGFBP7/SPARCL1 mean	20	0.0338	-0.0597 to 0.1673	5
B/plasma fraction	20	0.8592	0.8406 to 0.9122	0
Endothelial fraction	20	-0.3319	-0.4357 to -0.2195	0
Fibroblast fraction	20	0.0384	-0.0594 to 0.1426	6
Keratinocyte fraction	20	-0.5101	-0.6219 to -0.4264	0
Lymphatic endothelial fraction	20	-0.1967	-0.3760 to -0.1026	0
Mast-cell fraction	20	-0.3134	-0.4138 to -0.2213	0
Melanocyte fraction	20	-0.4625	-0.5757 to -0.4009	0
Myeloid fraction	20	0.3995	0.3041 to 0.4750	0
Pericyte/smooth-muscle fraction	20	0.0476	-0.0468 to 0.1363	3
Sweat-gland fraction	20	-0.6240	-0.6849 to -0.5721	0
T-cell fraction	20	0.6130	0.5595 to 0.6855	0
Numeric G specimen label	20	-0.3303	-0.4318 to -0.2573	0
Total retained cells	20	-0.0860	-0.2129 to 0.0071	1
Retained fibroblasts	20	0.0553	-0.0666 to 0.1461	3
Fibroblast dissociation score	20	0.3196	0.2231 to 0.4444	0
Fibroblast PTPRC-positive fraction	20	0.7725	0.7353 to 0.8309	0
Weighted specimen UMI medians	20	0.6622	0.6207 to 0.7725	0

Table S33. All six saved budget/panel diagnostic fits. These are not replacements for the frozen discovery fit: K=15 and batch size 128, with 16 training patients (60,861 cells) and four held patients (15,600 cells) from all clinical groups. Reconstruction equally weights fixed 128-cell evaluations per patient; it is cross-entropy in nats, without the KL term. The null is the same-panel equal-training-patient mean profile (6.74522 for inherited, 6.78361 for train-selected); raw errors from different panels cannot be ranked. Cosine summarizes all decoder row pairs after square-root transformation. Effective usage is the exponential entropy of the held mean topic weights, not a count of validated cell types. The engineering screen requires all last five absolute 100-step objective changes at most 0.001, separately for training and held patients; it is not mathematical convergence or a model-selection rule. Training-selected support and dispersion exclude held expression, but the gene universe and cell QC are discovery-derived. Historical reference-topic matching includes held discovery expression and supplies no independent construct validation. All fits, including failed screens, are retained.

Panel / genes	Steps / seed	Held recon.	Own-null diff.	Median cosine	Effective usage	Train / held screen
Inherited 7002	20k / 0	5.93852	-0.80670	0.508	9.352	Fail / fail
Inherited 7002	20k / 1	5.91006	-0.83516	0.508	10.498	Fail / fail
Inherited 7002	40k / 0	5.88759	-0.85763	0.355	10.484	Pass / fail
Inherited 7002	40k / 1	5.88567	-0.85956	0.345	10.551	Fail / fail
Train-selected 7003	20k / 0	5.96985	-0.81376	0.516	9.272	Fail / fail
Train-selected 7003	20k / 1	6.02562	-0.75799	0.515	9.532	Fail / fail

The saved-evidence extension retains the complete DFU-only covariate family, every single-patient omission, all six pooling contracts, all/train/held weighting summaries and all 120 patient–fit comparisons. These reuse the discovery patients and existing deterministic coordinates; they add no biological replication, clinical validation or replacement primary outcome values.

Table S34. Complete saved DFU-only covariate audit. All 31 covariates correlate with the fibroblast high-score fraction at the unchanged discovery cut 0.184295848, not with healing. The 14 DFU specimens map to 11 patients (seven healed, four non-healed); the mixed comparator contains these same patients plus nine non-diabetic patients, not an independent replication. Every full estimate has 11 finite pairs, and every one-patient omission has ten. The omission range is an influence diagnostic, not a confidence interval; E/A denotes estimable/attempted omissions, and flips count signs opposite to the full DFU estimate. Technical covariates retain fibroblast-count-weighted specimen summaries; weighted specimen UMI medians are not a pooled-patient median. No p values, BH discoveries, adjusted effects or causal conclusions are supplied.

Covariate	Pairs	ρ_{20}	ρ_{11}	Omission range	E/A	Flips
C01: Fibroblast topic 1 mean	11	0.5055	0.5727	0.4667 to 0.7455	11/11	0
C02: Fibroblast topic 2 mean	11	0.5024	-0.3182	-0.6606 to -0.1515	11/11	0
C03: Fibroblast topic 3 mean	11	0.5055	0.7000	0.6606 to 0.7697	11/11	0
C04: Fibroblast topic 4 mean	11	0.5608	0.6818	0.5758 to 0.7576	11/11	0
C05: Fibroblast topic 5 mean	11	0.1367	0.4364	0.3455 to 0.6242	11/11	0
C06: Fibroblast CFD/APOD mean (topic 6)	11	-0.7652	-0.2000	-0.3697 to 0.0424	11/11	2
C07: Fibroblast DCN/CFD mean (topic 7)	11	-0.6146	-0.0182	-0.1515 to 0.1636	11/11	3
C08: Fibroblast topic 8 mean	11	-0.0323	0.4364	0.3091 to 0.5879	11/11	0
C09: Fibroblast topic 9 mean	11	0.0338	0.3636	0.1879 to 0.5030	11/11	0
C10: Fibroblast topic 10 mean	11	-0.4732	0.1091	-0.0424 to 0.3576	11/11	2
C11: Fibroblast topic 11 mean	11	0.4978	0.5455	0.4545 to 0.6970	11/11	0

Continued on next page

Table S34 (continued)

Covariate	Pairs	ρ_{20}	ρ_{11}	Omission range	E/A	Flips
C12: Fibroblast topic 12 mean	11	0.7145	0.6182	0.5152 to 0.7455	11/11	0
C13: Fibroblast topic 13 mean	11	0.0077	0.2091	0.0545 to 0.5515	11/11	0
C14: Fibroblast topic 14 mean	11	0.3073	0.4455	0.2606 to 0.7333	11/11	0
C15: B/plasma-cell fraction	11	0.8592	0.8273	0.7697 to 0.8667	11/11	0
C16: Endothelial fraction	11	-0.3319	-0.3455	-0.4788 to -0.1273	11/11	0
C17: Fibroblast fraction	11	0.0384	-0.1364	-0.3212 to 0.0182	11/11	1
C18: Keratinocyte fraction	11	-0.5101	-0.2000	-0.3697 to 0.0667	11/11	2
C19: Lymphatic endothelial fraction	11	-0.1967	0.3000	0.0667 to 0.6121	11/11	0
C20: Mast-cell fraction	11	-0.3134	0.2909	0.1394 to 0.5394	11/11	0
C21: Melanocyte fraction	11	-0.4625	-0.2000	-0.4061 to 0.0667	11/11	1
C22: Myeloid fraction	11	0.3995	0.4091	0.2121 to 0.6485	11/11	0
C23: Pericyte/SMC fraction	11	0.0476	0.1545	0.0303 to 0.4061	11/11	0
C24: Sweat-gland fraction	11	-0.6240	-0.0456	-0.2121 to 0.2242	11/11	2
C25: T-cell fraction	11	0.6130	0.2364	-0.0182 to 0.4909	11/11	1
C26: Total recovered cell count	11	-0.0860	-0.4182	-0.6848 to -0.2485	11/11	0
C27: Recovered fibroblast count	11	0.0553	-0.1545	-0.4424 to 0.0303	11/11	1
C28: Weighted specimen dissociation score	11	0.3196	0.2818	0.0424 to 0.5030	11/11	0
C29: Weighted specimen median UMI count	11	0.6622	0.4545	0.2727 to 0.6242	11/11	0
C30: Weighted specimen PTPRC positivity	11	0.7725	0.4909	0.3212 to 0.7576	11/11	0
C31: Mean specimen G identifier	11	-0.3303	0.0091	-0.2121 to 0.1636	11/11	3

Table S35. All 341 saved leave-one-patient-out correlations, retaining every covariate and patient omission. C01–C31 follow the fixed family order printed with the covariate labels. S01–S11 abbreviate author-mapped identifiers NCOMMS2022_S01–NCOMMS2022_S11. Each entry uses the remaining ten DFU patients with no missing pairs. Positive and negative entries are retained; these are influence diagnostics, not confidence limits or replicated outcomes.

Covariate	S01	S02	S03	S04	S05	S06	S07	S08	S09	S10	S11
C01	0.5515	0.7455	0.4909	0.5636	0.4667	0.5758	0.5515	0.5515	0.5879	0.6485	0.5152
C02	-0.2848	-0.2848	-0.2364	-0.3576	-0.1515	-0.6606	-0.2606	-0.3576	-0.3212	-0.3212	-0.2364
C03	0.6848	0.7333	0.6727	0.7333	0.6727	0.6727	0.6606	0.6606	0.6848	0.7697	0.6727
C04	0.6848	0.7576	0.6364	0.7576	0.5758	0.6000	0.6606	0.7091	0.6848	0.7576	0.6242
C05	0.4303	0.4303	0.3455	0.6242	0.5030	0.3455	0.4424	0.3818	0.3939	0.4909	0.3455
C06	-0.2242	-0.2000	-0.3697	-0.1758	0.0061	0.0424	-0.2970	-0.2000	-0.2242	-0.1636	-0.3697
C07	0.1636	-0.1152	-0.0909	-0.0545	-0.1515	0.1152	-0.0303	-0.0303	0.1636	-0.0424	-0.1152
C08	0.4424	0.5879	0.3333	0.4909	0.3091	0.4061	0.4424	0.4424	0.4424	0.5152	0.3333
C09	0.3576	0.5030	0.2242	0.5030	0.1879	0.4061	0.3576	0.3697	0.3697	0.4303	0.2485
C10	0.0545	0.3576	0.0303	0.1636	-0.0182	0.2000	0.1152	0.1152	0.0545	0.1394	-0.0424
C11	0.5030	0.6970	0.4909	0.4909	0.4545	0.6000	0.5636	0.5152	0.5152	0.6242	0.4909
C12	0.6121	0.7091	0.5152	0.7455	0.5394	0.5152	0.6606	0.6242	0.6121	0.6606	0.5394
C13	0.1273	0.5515	0.1515	0.2364	0.0545	0.2485	0.2121	0.1515	0.1758	0.2242	0.1515
C14	0.4667	0.7333	0.3697	0.3939	0.2606	0.3697	0.4424	0.4182	0.4667	0.5636	0.3818
C15	0.8303	0.8667	0.8424	0.7939	0.7697	0.7939	0.8545	0.8667	0.8061	0.8061	0.8182
C16	-0.4182	-0.1273	-0.4788	-0.1273	-0.4667	-0.4667	-0.3697	-0.3697	-0.1879	-0.3697	-0.3818
C17	-0.0303	-0.3212	-0.1636	0.0182	-0.1636	-0.1636	-0.2000	-0.1636	-0.0303	-0.2121	-0.0303
C18	-0.2485	-0.1515	-0.3697	0.0667	0.0667	-0.3697	-0.2121	-0.2485	-0.2848	-0.1879	-0.2364
C19	0.1758	0.6121	0.3091	0.0667	0.3818	0.3212	0.3818	0.2727	0.1758	0.2727	0.3091
C20	0.1394	0.3091	0.4424	0.1879	0.1515	0.5394	0.3212	0.2727	0.2485	0.2606	0.2970
C21	-0.2727	-0.1152	-0.4061	-0.1152	0.0667	-0.1152	-0.2121	-0.2485	-0.1879	-0.1758	-0.4061
C22	0.4061	0.3455	0.4303	0.2121	0.2121	0.6485	0.4182	0.4182	0.4667	0.4182	0.4909
C23	0.1515	0.0424	0.4061	0.1879	0.0303	0.2242	0.1394	0.1879	0.0909	0.1273	0.1030
C24	-0.1094	0.1094	-0.2121	0.2242	-0.0304	-0.0304	-0.0365	-0.1094	-0.1094	-0.0486	-0.1702
C25	0.2364	0.3333	0.2121	0.1879	-0.0182	0.4909	0.2364	0.2121	0.2121	0.3455	0.1394
C26	-0.3818	-0.6848	-0.3697	-0.2970	-0.3455	-0.2485	-0.4424	-0.4909	-0.4061	-0.5394	-0.3697
C27	-0.0667	-0.4424	-0.1273	0.0303	-0.1879	-0.1273	-0.1515	-0.2364	-0.0424	-0.2242	-0.1030
C28	0.2848	0.5030	0.2121	0.1515	0.0424	0.2606	0.3455	0.3091	0.2606	0.4061	0.2970
C29	0.4909	0.4909	0.2970	0.3576	0.2727	0.3455	0.5273	0.5152	0.4788	0.5515	0.6242
C30	0.4182	0.4182	0.4545	0.3212	0.3212	0.7576	0.5394	0.5152	0.5152	0.5515	0.5515
C31	0.1636	0.0424	-0.2121	0.0424	-0.1273	0.0788	0.0424	0.0667	-0.0788	0.0424	0.0424

Table S36. Saved contracts for all six pooling-bridge fits. I and T identify the inherited 7,002-gene and training-selected 7,003-gene panels; fit labels then give budget in thousands of steps and seed. Topic IDs are zero-based saved one-to-one reference assignments, and each cut was estimated from training-patient fibroblasts only. The bridge preserves these contracts without a new fit, assignment, encoder call, threshold fit or checkpoint reload. Each fit reuses the same 20 patients, split into 16 optimization-training and four held patients. Upstream QC/gene-universe processing and the discovery reference remain inherited; the reference includes held expression. These diagnostic readouts do not replace primary frozen discovery values or constitute independent clinical validation.

Fit	Saved job ID	Panel	Seed	Steps	Topic	Saved cut
I20/0	`f70f148851e12b4431e0`	Inherited	0	20000	11	0.022523826
I20/1	`76f6368750875d30ac81`	Inherited	1	20000	9	0.218072171
I40/0	`57273c639c00f1b27572`	Inherited	0	40000	11	0.094846275
I40/1	`095ba103be7c93beace8`	Inherited	1	40000	9	0.223476775
T20/0	`f0d9c1f2d7a5a85bea3c`	Train-selected	0	20000	14	0.021614843
T20/1	`9e7d88c22b55e04da892`	Train-selected	1	20000	5	0.117400148

Table S37. Complete pooling summaries for all six fits and all/train/held partitions. Pooling combines recovered fibroblasts within patient; the comparator equally weights specimen fibroblast summaries. ΔM and ΔW are pooled minus equal-specimen mean loading and high-score fraction, respectively; the high rule is strictly above each saved training cut. Means equally weight patients in the named partition, and maxima are patient absolute differences. R counts patients with repeated specimens; H/N/D gives healed, non-healed and non-diabetic patient counts. Single-specimen differences are zero. The 120 patient-fit rows reuse 20 people, not 120 independent outcomes. No outcome comparison or resampling is performed.

Fit	Split	N	R	H/N/D	Mean ΔM	Max $\lvert\Delta M\rvert$	Mean ΔW	Max $\lvert\Delta W\rvert$
I20/0	all	20	5	7/4/9	0.000051	0.001502	0.002171	0.073750
I20/0	train	16	4	4/3/9	0.000054	0.001502	0.002428	0.073750
I20/0	held	4	1	3/1/0	0.000038	0.000151	0.001145	0.004579
I20/1	all	20	5	7/4/9	-0.004348	0.091484	-0.006074	0.126804
I20/1	train	16	4	4/3/9	-0.005725	0.091484	-0.007919	0.126804
I20/1	held	4	1	3/1/0	0.001163	0.004652	0.001304	0.005217
I40/0	all	20	5	7/4/9	-0.000590	0.012600	-0.002115	0.048288
I40/0	train	16	4	4/3/9	-0.000823	0.012600	-0.003067	0.048288
I40/0	held	4	1	3/1/0	0.000341	0.001363	0.001694	0.006774
I40/1	all	20	5	7/4/9	-0.003883	0.082733	-0.006027	0.125826
I40/1	train	16	4	4/3/9	-0.005206	0.082733	-0.007932	0.125826
I40/1	held	4	1	3/1/0	0.001406	0.005624	0.001593	0.006370
T20/0	all	20	5	7/4/9	0.000045	0.001485	0.002189	0.068937
T20/0	train	16	4	4/3/9	0.000051	0.001485	0.002260	0.068937
T20/0	held	4	1	3/1/0	0.000023	0.000092	0.001905	0.007621
T20/1	all	20	5	7/4/9	-0.001133	0.024770	-0.004167	0.088789
T20/1	train	16	4	4/3/9	-0.001607	0.024770	-0.005605	0.088789
T20/1	held	4	1	3/1/0	0.000759	0.003036	0.001583	0.006333

Table S38. All 120 saved patient-fit pooling comparisons. S01–S11 and S19–S27 abbreviate the author-mapped NCOMMS2022 patient identifiers. The intact-donor labels 12–20 in the patient summary correspond, in order, to S19–S27 here. Sp and F are contributing specimen and recovered fibroblast counts. Subscripts P and E indicate cell-pooled and equal-specimen summaries; $\Delta M = M_P - M_E$ and $\Delta W = W_P - W_E$. Equal-specimen means are recalculated from the saved values in float64; historical float32 means were verified within 10^{-7} and fractions within 10^{-12}. Values are descriptive and conditional on each saved topic and training-only cut; no primary discovery readout is replaced and no additional biological unit is created.

Fit	Patient	Split	Sp	F	M_P	M_E	W_P	W_E	ΔM	ΔW
I20/0	S01	train	1	221	0.029212	0.029212	0.696833	0.696833	0.000000	0.000000
I20/0	S02	held	2	2751	0.020871	0.020720	0.360596	0.356017	0.000151	0.004579
I20/0	S03	train	1	1238	0.013096	0.013096	0.084006	0.084006	0.000000	0.000000
I20/0	S04	held	1	356	0.025912	0.025912	0.539326	0.539326	0.000000	0.000000
I20/0	S05	train	1	843	0.013167	0.013167	0.053381	0.053381	0.000000	0.000000
I20/0	S06	train	2	1552	0.018985	0.019205	0.293170	0.306231	-0.000220	-0.013061
I20/0	S07	held	1	872	0.020931	0.020931	0.325688	0.325688	0.000000	0.000000
I20/0	S08	train	2	1605	0.025328	0.023826	0.530218	0.456468	0.001502	0.073750
I20/0	S09	train	1	363	0.026720	0.026720	0.528926	0.528926	0.000000	0.000000
I20/0	S10	train	1	170	0.031066	0.031066	0.670588	0.670588	0.000000	0.000000
I20/0	S11	held	1	1821	0.014291	0.014291	0.112026	0.112026	0.000000	0.000000
I20/0	S19	train	1	1020	0.020061	0.020061	0.278431	0.278431	0.000000	0.000000
I20/0	S20	train	1	215	0.021234	0.021234	0.409302	0.409302	0.000000	0.000000
I20/0	S21	train	2	1921	0.018233	0.018237	0.245705	0.246134	-0.000004	-0.000429
I20/0	S22	train	1	1152	0.018082	0.018082	0.203993	0.203993	0.000000	0.000000
I20/0	S23	train	2	1562	0.019825	0.020243	0.353393	0.374811	-0.000418	-0.021418
I20/0	S24	train	1	153	0.017132	0.017132	0.235294	0.235294	0.000000	0.000000
I20/0	S25	train	1	974	0.014958	0.014958	0.134497	0.134497	0.000000	0.000000
I20/0	S26	train	1	425	0.024191	0.024191	0.411765	0.411765	0.000000	0.000000
I20/0	S27	train	1	196	0.031919	0.031919	0.765306	0.765306	0.000000	0.000000
I20/1	S01	train	1	221	0.363602	0.363602	0.601810	0.601810	0.000000	0.000000
I20/1	S02	held	2	2751	0.429881	0.425229	0.607052	0.601835	0.004652	0.005217
I20/1	S03	train	1	1238	0.072173	0.072173	0.059774	0.059774	0.000000	0.000000
I20/1	S04	held	1	356	0.530645	0.530645	0.839888	0.839888	0.000000	0.000000
I20/1	S05	train	1	843	0.016262	0.016262	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
I20/1	S06	train	2	1552	0.018549	0.018819	0.000644	0.000540	-0.000270	0.000104
I20/1	S07	held	1	872	0.134761	0.134761	0.183486	0.183486	0.000000	0.000000
I20/1	S08	train	2	1605	0.311616	0.403100	0.452336	0.579140	-0.091484	-0.126804
I20/1	S09	train	1	363	0.335947	0.335947	0.526171	0.526171	0.000000	0.000000
I20/1	S10	train	1	170	0.117623	0.117623	0.111765	0.111765	0.000000	0.000000
I20/1	S11	held	1	1821	0.124547	0.124547	0.177375	0.177375	0.000000	0.000000
I20/1	S19	train	1	1020	0.699767	0.699767	0.925490	0.925490	0.000000	0.000000
I20/1	S20	train	1	215	0.033230	0.033230	0.009302	0.009302	0.000000	0.000000
I20/1	S21	train	2	1921	0.016098	0.016060	0.000000	0.000000	0.000038	0.000000
I20/1	S22	train	1	1152	0.014406	0.014406	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
I20/1	S23	train	2	1562	0.016678	0.016567	0.000000	0.000000	0.000111	0.000000
I20/1	S24	train	1	153	0.015665	0.015665	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
I20/1	S25	train	1	974	0.014987	0.014987	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
I20/1	S26	train	1	425	0.016870	0.016870	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
I20/1	S27	train	1	196	0.024999	0.024999	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
I40/0	S01	train	1	221	0.186536	0.186536	0.565611	0.565611	0.000000	0.000000
I40/0	S02	held	2	2751	0.198750	0.197387	0.582334	0.575559	0.001363	0.006774
I40/0	S03	train	1	1238	0.022491	0.022491	0.031502	0.031502	0.000000	0.000000
I40/0	S04	held	1	356	0.246773	0.246773	0.752809	0.752809	0.000000	0.000000
I40/0	S05	train	1	843	0.011138	0.011138	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
I40/0	S06	train	2	1552	0.018575	0.019034	0.007732	0.008550	-0.000458	-0.000818
I40/0	S07	held	1	872	0.043259	0.043259	0.111239	0.111239	0.000000	0.000000
I40/0	S08	train	2	1605	0.097294	0.109894	0.338941	0.387229	-0.012600	-0.048288
I40/0	S09	train	1	363	0.168759	0.168759	0.534435	0.534435	0.000000	0.000000

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Table S38 (continued)

Fit	Patient	Split	Sp	F	M_P	M_E	W_P	W_E	ΔM	ΔW
I40/0	S10	train	1	170	0.083874	0.083874	0.335294	0.335294	0.000000	0.000000
I40/0	S11	held	1	1821	0.042081	0.042081	0.104887	0.104887	0.000000	0.000000
I40/0	S19	train	1	1020	0.291385	0.291385	0.845098	0.845098	0.000000	0.000000
I40/0	S20	train	1	215	0.025795	0.025795	0.023256	0.023256	0.000000	0.000000
I40/0	S21	train	2	1921	0.012936	0.012927	0.000521	0.000490	0.000009	0.000030
I40/0	S22	train	1	1152	0.012622	0.012622	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
I40/0	S23	train	2	1562	0.015771	0.015887	0.000000	0.000000	-0.000116	0.000000
I40/0	S24	train	1	153	0.014842	0.014842	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
I40/0	S25	train	1	974	0.012723	0.012723	0.002053	0.002053	0.000000	0.000000
I40/0	S26	train	1	425	0.016724	0.016724	0.002353	0.002353	0.000000	0.000000
I40/0	S27	train	1	196	0.037006	0.037006	0.056122	0.056122	0.000000	0.000000
I40/1	S01	train	1	221	0.398724	0.398724	0.642534	0.642534	0.000000	0.000000
I40/1	S02	held	2	2751	0.434414	0.428790	0.633951	0.627581	0.005624	0.006370
I40/1	S03	train	1	1238	0.048628	0.048628	0.042003	0.042003	0.000000	0.000000
I40/1	S04	held	1	356	0.539064	0.539064	0.876404	0.876404	0.000000	0.000000
I40/1	S05	train	1	843	0.015275	0.015275	0.001186	0.001186	0.000000	0.000000
I40/1	S06	train	2	1552	0.022297	0.022955	0.004510	0.005332	-0.000658	-0.000822
I40/1	S07	held	1	872	0.114796	0.114796	0.143349	0.143349	0.000000	0.000000
I40/1	S08	train	2	1605	0.282829	0.365562	0.426791	0.552618	-0.082733	-0.125826
I40/1	S09	train	1	363	0.366800	0.366800	0.586777	0.586777	0.000000	0.000000
I40/1	S10	train	1	170	0.128972	0.128972	0.182353	0.182353	0.000000	0.000000
I40/1	S11	held	1	1821	0.103080	0.103080	0.142779	0.142779	0.000000	0.000000
I40/1	S19	train	1	1020	0.746395	0.746395	0.974510	0.974510	0.000000	0.000000
I40/1	S20	train	1	215	0.044751	0.044751	0.018605	0.018605	0.000000	0.000000
I40/1	S21	train	2	1921	0.015830	0.015812	0.000000	0.000000	0.000018	0.000000
I40/1	S22	train	1	1152	0.015024	0.015024	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
I40/1	S23	train	2	1562	0.017837	0.017754	0.000640	0.000896	0.000083	-0.000256
I40/1	S24	train	1	153	0.017175	0.017175	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
I40/1	S25	train	1	974	0.015733	0.015733	0.001027	0.001027	0.000000	0.000000
I40/1	S26	train	1	425	0.017369	0.017369	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
I40/1	S27	train	1	196	0.024653	0.024653	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
T20/0	S01	train	1	221	0.023510	0.023510	0.475113	0.475113	0.000000	0.000000
T20/0	S02	held	2	2751	0.017220	0.017128	0.201018	0.193397	0.000092	0.007621
T20/0	S03	train	1	1238	0.012183	0.012183	0.068659	0.068659	0.000000	0.000000
T20/0	S04	held	1	356	0.021477	0.021477	0.337079	0.337079	0.000000	0.000000
T20/0	S05	train	1	843	0.011429	0.011429	0.023725	0.023725	0.000000	0.000000
T20/0	S06	train	2	1552	0.017163	0.017385	0.255155	0.267129	-0.000222	-0.011974
T20/0	S07	held	1	872	0.018292	0.018292	0.238532	0.238532	0.000000	0.000000
T20/0	S08	train	2	1605	0.022692	0.021208	0.423676	0.354739	0.001485	0.068937
T20/0	S09	train	1	363	0.022832	0.022832	0.399449	0.399449	0.000000	0.000000
T20/0	S10	train	1	170	0.028877	0.028877	0.552941	0.552941	0.000000	0.000000
T20/0	S11	held	1	1821	0.012245	0.012245	0.074684	0.074684	0.000000	0.000000
T20/0	S19	train	1	1020	0.014669	0.014669	0.114706	0.114706	0.000000	0.000000
T20/0	S20	train	1	215	0.018291	0.018291	0.213953	0.213953	0.000000	0.000000
T20/0	S21	train	2	1921	0.016191	0.016193	0.186361	0.186367	-0.000002	-0.000006
T20/0	S22	train	1	1152	0.016072	0.016072	0.157118	0.157118	0.000000	0.000000
T20/0	S23	train	2	1562	0.017923	0.018371	0.288092	0.308888	-0.000448	-0.020796
T20/0	S24	train	1	153	0.015146	0.015146	0.202614	0.202614	0.000000	0.000000
T20/0	S25	train	1	974	0.013148	0.013148	0.094456	0.094456	0.000000	0.000000
T20/0	S26	train	1	425	0.022375	0.022375	0.374118	0.374118	0.000000	0.000000
T20/0	S27	train	1	196	0.030152	0.030152	0.693878	0.693878	0.000000	0.000000
T20/1	S01	train	1	221	0.149939	0.149939	0.393665	0.393665	0.000000	0.000000
T20/1	S02	held	2	2751	0.162038	0.159001	0.356598	0.350264	0.003036	0.006333
T20/1	S03	train	1	1238	0.019324	0.019324	0.015347	0.015347	0.000000	0.000000
T20/1	S04	held	1	356	0.184831	0.184831	0.525281	0.525281	0.000000	0.000000
T20/1	S05	train	1	843	0.009392	0.009392	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
T20/1	S06	train	2	1552	0.014022	0.014311	0.001289	0.001597	-0.000289	-0.000309
T20/1	S07	held	1	872	0.025672	0.025672	0.036697	0.036697	0.000000	0.000000
T20/1	S08	train	2	1605	0.071106	0.095875	0.176947	0.265736	-0.024770	-0.088789
T20/1	S09	train	1	363	0.116125	0.116125	0.289256	0.289256	0.000000	0.000000
T20/1	S10	train	1	170	0.037588	0.037588	0.052941	0.052941	0.000000	0.000000
T20/1	S11	held	1	1821	0.021920	0.021920	0.011532	0.011532	0.000000	0.000000
T20/1	S19	train	1	1020	0.301347	0.301347	0.744118	0.744118	0.000000	0.000000
T20/1	S20	train	1	215	0.014353	0.014353	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
T20/1	S21	train	2	1921	0.012433	0.012499	0.001041	0.001110	-0.000066	-0.000069
T20/1	S22	train	1	1152	0.012710	0.012710	0.001736	0.001736	0.000000	0.000000
T20/1	S23	train	2	1562	0.014318	0.014898	0.001280	0.001792	-0.000580	-0.000512
T20/1	S24	train	1	153	0.011051	0.011051	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
T20/1	S25	train	1	974	0.010787	0.010787	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
T20/1	S26	train	1	425	0.015254	0.015254	0.002353	0.002353	0.000000	0.000000
T20/1	S27	train	1	196	0.019433	0.019433	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000

The fixed capacity/seed extension retains every inference checkpoint, every one-to-one topic assignment and every person-specific readout, including missing matches. The compact tables describe all nine fits and seed dispersion without assigning biological replication to the grid.

Table S39. Every fixed 40,000-step topic fit and its primary one-to-one reference match. Correlation is calculated on square-root decoder probabilities. The specimen mean–fraction association uses the fit-specific full-discovery fibroblast cut and is descriptive. Unmatched reference topics, including capacity-constrained omissions at K=10, are retained. No seed or match-quality threshold selects the primary result.

K	Seed	Primary match	Decoder r	Mean–fraction rho	Unmatched reference
10	0	assigned	0.817	0.946	5
10	1	assigned	0.938	0.916	5
10	2	assigned	0.965	0.906	5
15	0	assigned	0.980	0.922	0
15	1	assigned	0.982	0.918	0
15	2	assigned	0.746	0.950	0
20	0	assigned	0.988	0.912	0
20	1	assigned	0.832	0.933	0
20	2	assigned	0.604	0.925	0

Table S40. All five conditional density comparisons for every capacity/seed fit. Positive transformed-score log-density differences favor the first family. Each cell gives the specimen median in nats/cell, the number of people favoring the first family in parentheses (out of 20), and the full range of equal-specimen patient means on its second line; these are not confidence intervals. M1/M2 reweight shared components, C1/C2 shift or shift-and-scale a continuous shared shape, and H1 weights cut-separated reference components by the training-half high-score fraction. These conditional scores exclude the scored patient from reference-density fitting but not from expression-representation training. All values are descriptive nats/cell, without state identification or sign-test inference.

K	Seed	M1 vs C1	M2 vs C2	M1 vs C2	H1 vs C1	M1 vs H1
10	0	0.095 (16/20)	0.053 (18/20)	0.023 (15/20)	0.076 (14/20)	0.030 (16/20)
		[-0.475, 0.371]	[-0.024, 0.248]	[-0.492, 0.254]	[-0.404, 0.282]	[-0.070, 0.166]
10	1	0.204 (14/20)	0.072 (16/20)	0.043 (12/20)	0.141 (15/20)	0.039 (14/20)
		[-0.376, 0.949]	[-0.155, 0.247]	[-0.406, 0.185]	[-0.506, 0.953]	[-0.113, 0.221]
10	2	0.208 (14/20)	0.055 (15/20)	0.022 (11/20)	0.139 (15/20)	0.043 (13/20)
		[-0.330, 0.835]	[-0.053, 0.275]	[-0.366, 0.253]	[-0.464, 0.836]	[-0.100, 0.210]
15	0	0.235 (14/20)	0.070 (17/20)	0.044 (13/20)	0.178 (13/20)	0.051 (13/20)
		[-0.374, 1.027]	[-0.163, 0.385]	[-0.394, 0.267]	[-0.492, 1.037]	[-0.102, 0.255]
15	1	0.222 (13/20)	0.050 (13/20)	-0.001 (8/20)	0.166 (13/20)	0.048 (13/20)
		[-0.452, 1.050]	[-0.149, 0.413]	[-0.580, 0.295]	[-0.525, 1.064]	[-0.041, 0.238]
15	2	0.173 (14/20)	0.055 (16/20)	0.023 (10/20)	0.115 (14/20)	0.038 (19/20)
		[-0.395, 0.640]	[-0.063, 0.239]	[-0.389, 0.190]	[-0.409, 0.565]	[-0.006, 0.261]
20	0	0.251 (14/20)	0.084 (16/20)	0.060 (12/20)	0.201 (15/20)	0.061 (14/20)
		[-0.430, 1.123]	[-0.143, 0.542]	[-0.445, 0.433]	[-0.521, 1.143]	[-0.040, 0.283]
20	1	0.218 (14/20)	0.047 (16/20)	-0.008 (9/20)	0.168 (14/20)	0.043 (17/20)
		[-0.562, 0.758]	[-0.097, 0.269]	[-0.581, 0.247]	[-0.553, 0.699]	[-0.090, 0.259]
20	2	0.130 (14/20)	0.056 (14/20)	0.017 (10/20)	0.099 (14/20)	0.024 (20/20)
		[-0.414, 0.775]	[-0.122, 0.252]	[-0.412, 0.180]	[-0.431, 0.672]	[0.004, 0.214]

Table S41. Computational seed dispersion in all 20 mapped people, separately by capacity, readout and population. For each person the range spans the three seeds; the table summarizes those person-specific ranges. Complete counts name people with all three estimable readouts. Equal-specimen means within patient are used only in this sensitivity experiment, not as replacements for the primary cell-pooled outcome measurements. Each fit has its own topic and descriptive fibroblast cut; cross-fit biological scale and patient confidence intervals are not implied.

K	Population	Readout	Complete /20	Median range	Maximum range
10	all cells	Fraction above cut	20	0.034	0.160
10	all cells	Mean loading	20	0.011	0.112
10	fibroblast only	Fraction above cut	20	0.029	0.365
10	fibroblast only	Mean loading	20	0.011	0.226
15	all cells	Fraction above cut	20	0.014	0.173
15	all cells	Mean loading	20	0.007	0.058
15	fibroblast only	Fraction above cut	20	0.005	0.331
15	fibroblast only	Mean loading	20	0.006	0.230
20	all cells	Fraction above cut	20	0.035	0.109
20	all cells	Mean loading	20	0.009	0.101
20	fibroblast only	Fraction above cut	20	0.011	0.357
20	fibroblast only	Mean loading	20	0.008	0.277

Clinical covariates were compared within the 11 DFU patients by exact rank-sum allocation and the Hodges–Lehmann shift; sex used the Fisher probability. Readout correlations used 20,000 covariate permutations. Separately, three frozen topic-0 decoder scores were applied to 12 bulk foot samples after mapping transcript clusters to genes and standardizing each gene across samples. The scores are the 50 largest topic-0 weights, a 50-gene lift-ranked set: among mapped overlapping genes above the 90th percentile of topic-0 weights over the full decoder panel, select the largest $\beta_{0g} / \max(15^{-1} \sum_{k=0}^{14} \beta_{kg}, 10^{-12})$ values. The deposited gene list fixes its selected membership and ordering. The third score is the weight-averaged overlap. Transcript-cluster expression is averaged within each mapped gene; each retained gene is standardized across the 12 samples using the sample standard deviation, and each 50-gene score averages its gene profiles equally. The primary universe is the full mapped array. The submitters' ulcer-versus-intact gene list is only a sensitivity. Exact sample relabelling and 4,000 size-matched random gene sets describe those scores. Neither analysis adjusts the healing contrast or adds patients. The bulk series is not a healing cohort. The clinical-balance and bulk-wound tables retain every covariate, every readout correlation and every prespecified score, including contrasts compatible with label exchange.

Table S42. Clinical balance among the 11 DFU patients. Medians are followed by the number of finite values. The shift is the Hodges–Lehmann median of all healed-minus-non-healed pairwise differences. Exact rank probabilities enumerate every allocation of the observed values; sex uses the two-sided Fisher probability. HbA1c is missing for three healed patients and diabetes duration for one. These comparisons do not adjust the healing contrast and do not establish equivalence.

Covariate	Healed	Non-healed	Shift	Exact p
Age (years)	63.00 (7)	52.50 (4)	9.00	0.291
BMI	34.86 (7)	36.35 (4)	-1.20	0.788
HbA1c	8.50 (4)	7.60 (4)	0.55	0.400
Wound area (cm^2)	1.00 (7)	1.15 (4)	-0.10	0.961
Diabetes duration (years)	13.00 (6)	12.50 (4)	-0.50	1.000
Male	2/7	2/4	–	0.576

Table S43. Spearman correlations between the four patient readouts and the clinical covariates, using every finite pair. Probabilities come from 20,000 permutations of the covariate within the available patients. The complete family is shown. No correlation is a covariate-adjusted healing effect.

Readout	Covariate	n	Rho	Permutation p
All-cell mean	Age (years)	11	0.000	1.000
All-cell mean	BMI	11	0.400	0.231
All-cell mean	HbA1c	8	-0.036	0.946
All-cell mean	Wound area (cm^2)	11	0.159	0.637
All-cell mean	Diabetes duration (years)	10	0.476	0.164
Fibroblast mean	Age (years)	11	0.310	0.352
Fibroblast mean	BMI	11	-0.064	0.858
Fibroblast mean	HbA1c	8	-0.252	0.556
Fibroblast mean	Wound area (cm^2)	11	-0.178	0.599
Fibroblast mean	Diabetes duration (years)	10	0.177	0.617
High-score fraction	Age (years)	11	0.255	0.450
High-score fraction	BMI	11	0.009	0.990
High-score fraction	HbA1c	8	-0.252	0.556
High-score fraction	Wound area (cm^2)	11	-0.164	0.626
High-score fraction	Diabetes duration (years)	10	0.177	0.617
Composition	Age (years)	11	-0.146	0.668

Table S43 (continued)

Readout	Covariate	n	Rho	Permutation p
Composition	BMI	11	0.436	0.188
Composition	HbA1c	8	0.647	0.092
Composition	Wound area (cm^2)	11	0.005	0.996
Composition	Diabetes duration (years)	10	-0.122	0.735

Table S44. Frozen topic-0 decoder scores in 12 bulk foot samples: 6 ulcers, 3 diabetic intact samples and 3 non-diabetic intact samples. The full array is the primary universe. The DE-filtered sensitivity uses only the submitters' genes that already differ between ulcer and intact skin, so its random-gene distribution is not an independent control. Difference is the mean standardized score in the first named group minus the second. Exact probabilities relabel the samples in that contrast. The random column is the fraction of 4,000 size-matched gene sets whose difference was at least as far from zero; it is undefined for the weight-averaged score. Sample relabellings and gene sets do not add patients, and the series has no healing labels.

Universe	Score	Contrast	Difference	Exact p	Random
Full array	Highest 50 weights	Ulcer vs intact	-0.125	0.738	0.744
Full array	Highest 50 weights	Ulcer vs diabetic intact	-0.069	0.881	0.865
Full array	Highest 50 weights	Diabetic vs non-diabetic intact	-0.112	0.600	0.085
Full array	Topic-specific 50	Ulcer vs intact	0.662	0.0022	0.0043
Full array	Topic-specific 50	Ulcer vs diabetic intact	0.606	0.012	0.0092
Full array	Topic-specific 50	Diabetic vs non-diabetic intact	0.113	0.500	0.081
Full array	Weight-averaged overlap	Ulcer vs intact	-0.199	0.539	–
Full array	Weight-averaged overlap	Ulcer vs diabetic intact	-0.113	0.821	–
Full array	Weight-averaged overlap	Diabetic vs non-diabetic intact	-0.172	0.600	–
DE-filtered sensitivity	Highest 50 weights	Ulcer vs intact	0.035	0.864	1.000
DE-filtered sensitivity	Highest 50 weights	Ulcer vs diabetic intact	0.041	0.905	1.000
DE-filtered sensitivity	Highest 50 weights	Diabetic vs non-diabetic intact	-0.011	0.900	0.962
DE-filtered sensitivity	Topic-specific 50	Ulcer vs intact	0.575	0.011	0.916
DE-filtered sensitivity	Topic-specific 50	Ulcer vs diabetic intact	0.538	0.048	0.922
DE-filtered sensitivity	Topic-specific 50	Diabetic vs non-diabetic intact	0.075	0.800	0.569
DE-filtered sensitivity	Weight-averaged overlap	Ulcer vs intact	-0.227	0.195	–
DE-filtered sensitivity	Weight-averaged overlap	Ulcer vs diabetic intact	-0.190	0.512	–
DE-filtered sensitivity	Weight-averaged overlap	Diabetic vs non-diabetic intact	-0.073	0.600	–

Additional supporting displays

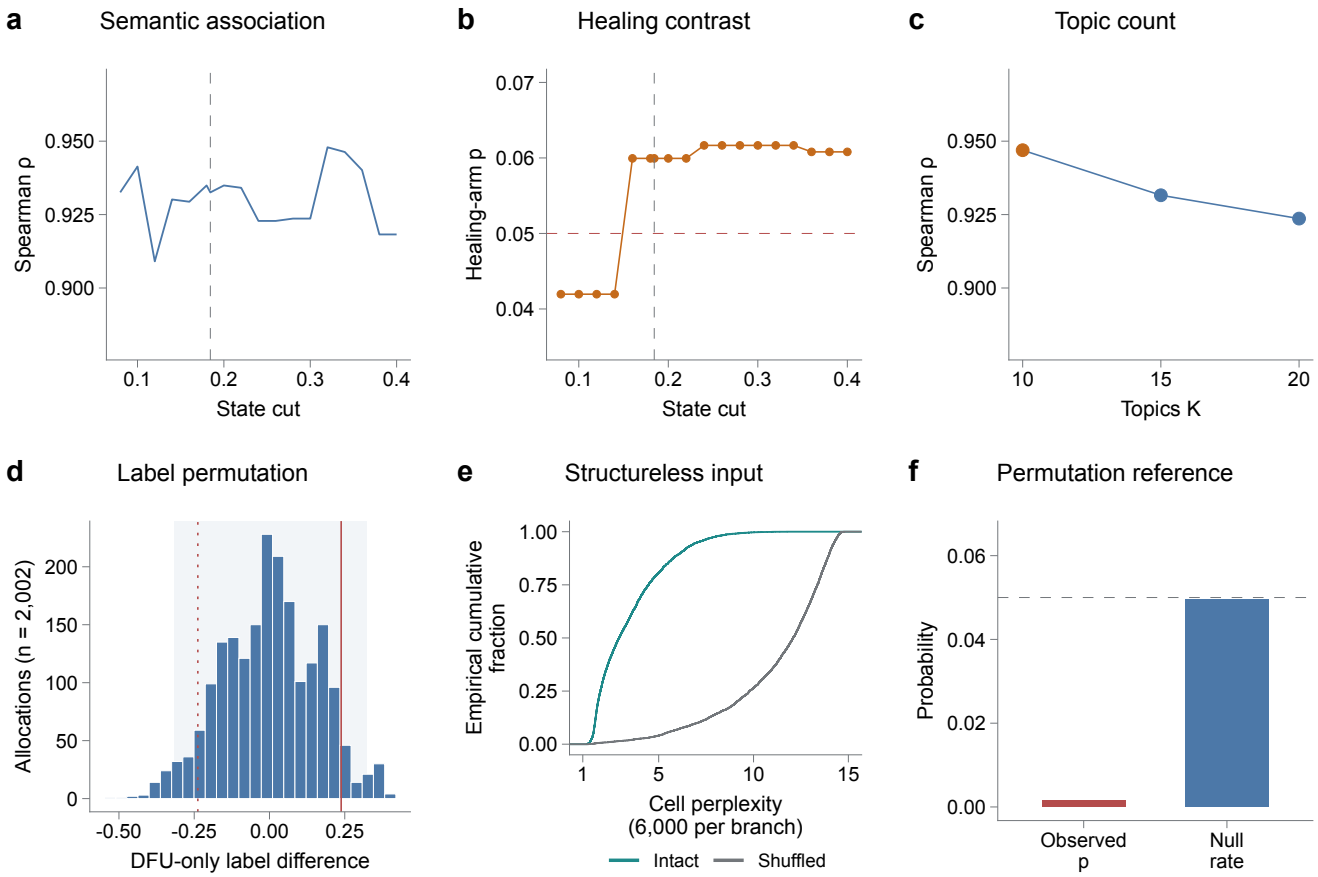


Figure S1. Threshold, capacity and negative-control analyses. (a) Mean–fraction correlation at 18 cuts across 25 specimens; dashed line: pooled cut. (b) Healing-arm Mann–Whitney probabilities for 9 versus 5 specimens; 4/18 are below 0.05. (c) Correlations at K=10, 15 and 20; orange marks K=10, where the healthy-skin maximum fails. (d) The complete saved distribution of 2,002 DFU-only label allocations, with central 95% shading, positive observed difference and its negative counterpart for the two-sided comparison (p=0.1199). (e) Empirical cumulative perplexity distributions of the 6,000 intact and 6,000 gene-shuffled cells. Their mean perplexities are 3.44 and 11.23 of 15; shuffling also changes row-library variation, so this is not a complete technical null. (f) The separate anatomical specimen-level permutation reference: observed p=0.0015 and 5.0% of permuted probabilities below 0.05. Cells and label allocations are computational units, not extra patients; repeated specimens limit inference, and no panel establishes pipeline-wide error control.

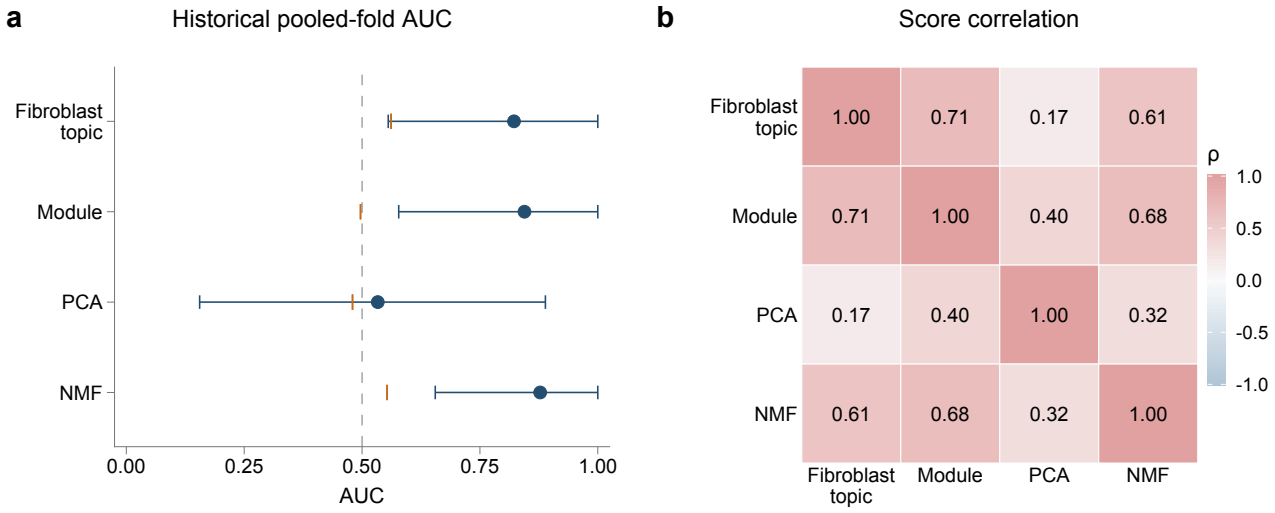


Figure S2. Historical scoring diagnostics in 14 DFU specimens (9 healing, 5 non-healing). (a) Leave-one-sample-out ROC areas (AUCs) with percentile 95% intervals from 4,000 arm-stratified bootstrap draws of fixed out-of-fold scores, using common resampling indices. Orange ticks: permutation-null means after rerunning outcome-dependent fitting and orientation; dashed line: 0.5, not the fitted null. Fibroblast topic is the frozen all-cell mean; Module is the specified fibro-inflammatory score; PCA and NMF denote principal component and nonnegative matrix readouts. Different fitted-fold coordinates and repeated patients prevent these pooled AUCs or intervals from supporting a representation ranking. (b) Spearman correlations of the same 14 specimen readouts; colours and numbers encode the same statistic. These are procedure diagnostics, not independent patient validation.

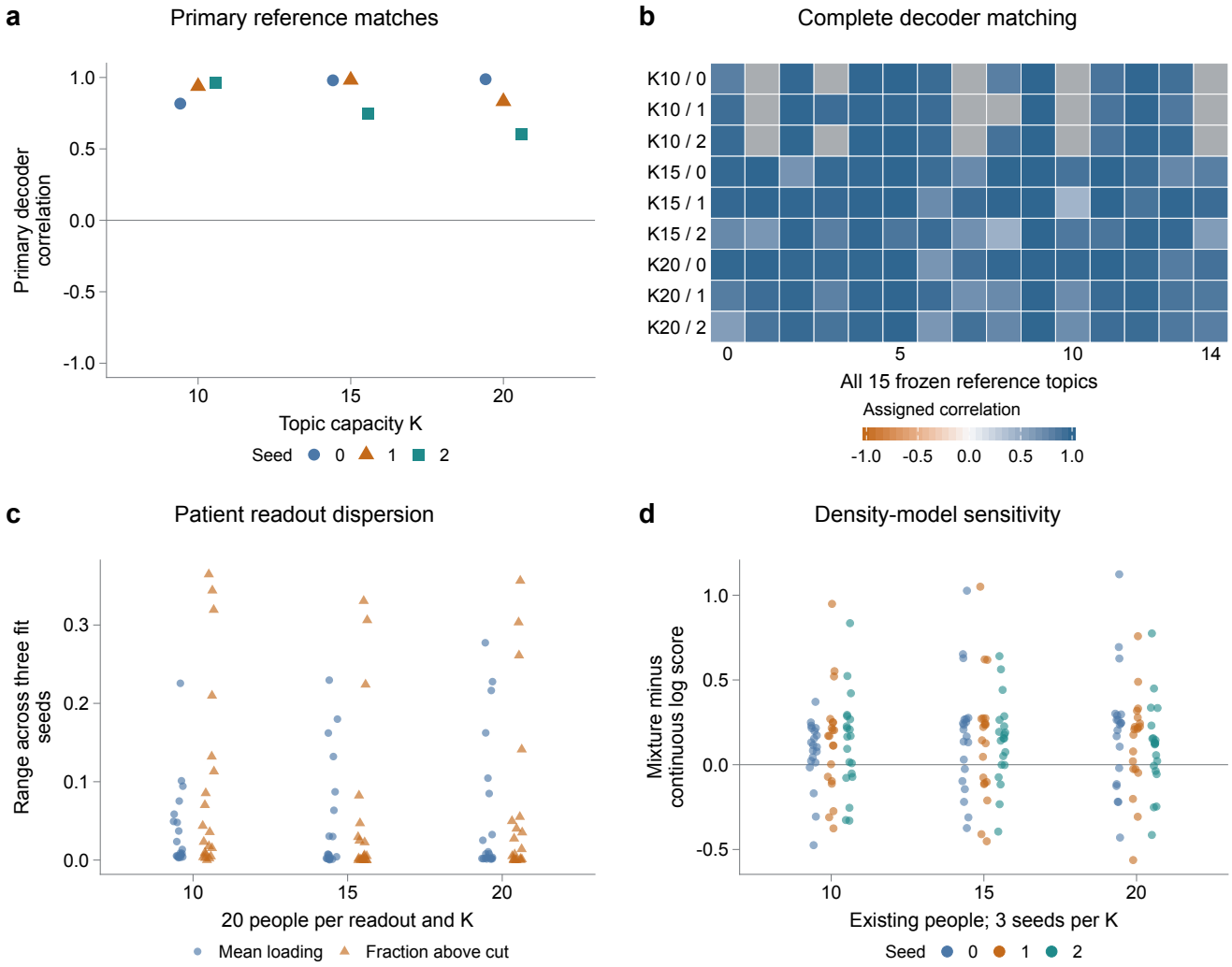


Figure S3. Prespecified capacity and training-seed sensitivities in the original discovery cohort. (a) All nine 40,000-step fits retain their one-to-one assigned match to frozen reference topic 0, without favorable-seed selection. Correlation compares square-root decoder gene probabilities; a missing primary match is unavailable rather than rescued with a rowwise best match. (b) Every reference-topic assignment is shown; gray cells are unmatched or undefined, not low-valued assigned correlations. Capacity K=10 necessarily leaves at least five of the 15 reference topics unmatched. (c) Each point is one existing person's range across three seeds at a fixed K, separately for mean loading and fraction above the fit-specific fibroblast cut. The plotted population is fibroblast-only; complete all-cell counterparts and unavailable counts accompany the tables. Equal-specimen means within patient define this sensitivity experiment, not the primary cell-pooled outcome estimand. (d) Points are person-averaged held-cell log-score differences for a two-component mixture versus a continuous density, on fit-specific transformed topic scores. Positive values favor the mixture under that predictive density comparison. Cell splits and threshold exclusions do not make the full-discovery trained representation independent. Seeds, capacities and points do not add biological patients or validate a discrete state, healing biomarker or amputation endpoint.

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